

MAN AND COP

PART I

cop: pull over.

man: this is a zip-up hoodie, not a jacket.

cop: very funny, now stop the car.

man: okay.

[man stops the car]

cop: do you know how fast you were going?

man: no.

cop: why not?

man: the speedometer is broken.

cop: how do you know?

man: because it says zero.

cop: shouldn't it be zero now that your car is stopped?

man: good point. Let me see what happens when i drive off again.

[the man drives off, leaving the cop in the dust]

[after speeding off to "test" the broken speedometer]

[ten minutes later...]

man (pulls to the side of the road, engine sputtering): huh. i think my car got tired. It stopped.

[ten minutes later, the same cop finally catches up in his cruiser and slams the door]

cop (marching over): YOU. RAN. FROM. ME.

man (smiling): not far. It got sleepy.

cop: you ran out of gas!?

man: yup. It was hungry but i forgot to feed it. My bad.

cop: i should absolutely give you a ticket right now!

man: sure! i always wanted to take a train to Japan anyway.

cop: what?

man: you said "ticket." planes are scary, so i figure trains are safer. Japan seems nice.

cop: i meant a traffic ticket!

man: oh. does that one go to Australia?

cop: no!

[four hours later...]

[they are still arguing. the sun is beginning to set. it is now 2:59 PM. the road is otherwise empty. the man is sitting on the curb playing with a stick. the cop is mid-rant, visibly twitching]

cop: -and you can't just ignore laws because your car is "feeling sleepy," and that's NOT how gas tanks work, and you can't call 9-1-1 to ask if your glovebox is haunted-

man: but it did smell like ghosts. And raisins.

cop: WHY would a ghost smell like raisins!?

man: it was old.

[three o' clock hits]

[a distant honk is heard. then another. suddenly, a never-ending stream of honking, angry commuters appears. a massive rush hour traffic jam is now backed up all the way to the man's stalled car and the cop standing beside it.]

driver #1: move your car!!

driver #2: what's going on up there!?

cop (looking around in horror): oh great. this is YOUR fault!

man: i love jam!

cop: what?

man: strawberry's my favorite. but traffic jam's kinda chewy. it tastes like basketballs.

cop (staring blankly): i'm going to need backup. And maybe a nap.

dispatcher (over radio): backup unavailable. you're on your own sir.

cop: (sighs, looking up at the sky) why me?

man: maybe because you're my guardian angler.

cop: ...angel?

man: nope. you kinda look like a fish.

[the traffic jam worsens. Someone starts playing saxophone out their car window. Another person begins selling hot dogs.]

[meanwhile, the cop silently walks over to the man's car, opens the fuel cap, stares into the empty tank, and just slowly mutters.]

cop: i went to police academy for this...

man: hey, do you think i could tow the car with a really long spaghetti noodle?

[later...]

[a tow truck finally arrives, weaving through the congested traffic. the operator gets out, exhausted and confused.]

tow truck guy: alright, whose vehicle needs towing?

cop (relieved): thank goodness. it's this guy. rn out of gas, caused this entire backup, and possibly thinks raisins are ghosts.

man: not all of them. only the wrinkly ones.

tow truck guy (rubbing temples): right... i'll get this hooked up.

[he walks toward the man's car with a tow chain. meanwhile, the man crouches near the tow truck's front wheel.]

man (thinking): "tow" starts with "t." so does "tire" And "trade." so this is clearly a tire-trading truck.

cop: wait. what are you-NO!

[before anyone can react, the man has already removed one of the tow truck's tires, rolled it over to his car, and swapped it with one of his own flat, beat-up wheels. The old tire is now on the tow truck like it belongs there.]

man (proudly): there! successful tire transaction completed.

tow truck guy: WHAT!? you took my wheel!?

man: i traded! fair and round.

cop (yelling): this isn't pokémon, you can't just TRADE PARTS OF A VEHICLE!

???: excuse me... did you just say Pokémon?

[everyone freezes. the air turns cold. the honking stops. from the horizon, a black SUV with a giant red N on the side screeches to a halt.]

man: woah. is that the Nacho Delivery Van?

cop: oh no. No no no.

[the SUV doors slam open in unison. four men in suits and red ties step out in perfect formation. their briefcases gleam menacingly in the afternoon sun.]

lead lawyer: Nintendo Legal Division, cease and desist squad. Did you say pokémon, officer?

cop: uh-i mean, not like officially. i was just making an example-!

lawyer #2: that's brand usage without a license.

lawyer #3 (cracking knuckles): and possibly intent to parody.

cop: wait wait wait! no parody! no parody!!

lawyer #1: article 3, section 7 of the Eternal Nintendo Scrolls. you say it, you pay it.

cop: i don't even own a switch!!

[the lawyers surround him like a legal SWAT team. the man watches cheerfully from the curb, licking an empty ketchup packet like it's a popsicle.]

man: is this one of those flash mobs? can i be a Pokémon too? i pick... chairasaur!

lawyer #4: that's not even- you know what? nevermind. he's protected under the "too dumb to sue" clause.

lawyer #2: it's true. we checked. he legally qualifies as a foghorn in three states.

cop (still being buried in cease & desist paperwork): HELP! he's the one who caused the whole jam!

man: mmm. jam.

lawyer #1 (pauses): what flavor?

man: basketball.

[the lawyers all slowly turn their heads in confusion. even they weren't ready for that.]

lawyer #3: ...right. we're done here.

lawyer #2: send the fine to the precinct. and a cease and desist to the word Pokémon.

lawyer #4: again

the Nintendo SUV peels out, but not before playing the Wii Shop Channel music at full blast.

tow truck guy (wide-eyed): i think i just saw four men serve legal documents in rhythm.

man: can they help me trade for an engine?

cop (now taped to a stop sign with legal notices): i hate tuesdays.

man: it's thursday.

cop: EVEN WORSE.

[meanwhile, the traffic jam has evolved into a full festival. food trucks arrive. someone sets up a stage. "TRAFFICSTOCK DAY" begins. people are waving tire-themed flags. the tow truck is being used as a DJ booth.]

cop (muffled under paperwork): i... used to write parking tickets...

man (dancing): t is for tow! t is for tire! t is for tuna!

tow truck guy: why tuna?

man: because fish rhymes with... honda.

tow truck guy: that's not even close.

man: shhh. the asphalt is listening.

cop (hoarse whisper): this... can't get any worse...

[SCREECH!]

[a second massive truck skids to a stop, this one plastered with a spray-painted logo that says "HOSS 2 U." the doors swing open, and a loud neigh shakes the traffic jam to its core.]

horse guy (yelling over honks): i brought the horse!!

cop: what?

horse guy: didn't you say "horse"? i got your request!

cop: i said worse-WORSE! as in "bad!" Not a-WAIT IS THAT HORSE FOAMING!?

[the majestic stallion hops down from the trailer ramp. it snorts once, then locks eyes with the man sitting nearby, who is currently chewing on a discarded keychain shaped like a donut.]

horse (snorts violently): PFFFFFFFFFTHHH

horse guy: uh-oh. he smells something... he only reacts like that when he smells mice.

man: i had a mouse sandwich for breakfast!

cop: WH-

[the horse completely loses it. It rears back, neighs like a banshee, and charges full speed at the man, who-amazingly-doesn't even blink.]

man: Is this a hug?

the horse barrels toward him, then suddenly skids to a halt, inches from trampling him. the air is still.]

horse guy (whispers dramatically): his name... is butt stallion.

[FLASH!]

[a glowing portal opens in midair. A team of stylized, overly enthusiastic Gearbox developers step through, clapping and tossing confetti.]

gearbox dev #1: did someone say butt stallion?

gearbox dev #2: that's a Borderlands reference! you, sir, are a legend!

horse guy: wait what!? i thought it was just a dumb name my cousin picked after getting kicked in the head!

gearbox dev #3: nope. It's canon now.

cop: i swear on every citation book i've ever owned-

gearbox dev #1: this calls for a celebration! bring in the loot piñata!

[A piñata shaped like a vending machine is lowered from a drone. people in the traffic jam start cheering and smacking it with selfie sticks and folding chairs.]

man (pointing at the loot piñata): i hope it's full of jam.

cop (muttering into his radio): dispatch, please. i need... a helicopter... a priest... and a new identity.

dispatcher (over radio): sir, we've rerouted all units. you're on your own. also, you've been trending for three hours under #ButtStallionSaga.

horse guy (climbing back into his truck): i'm leaving before he tries to marry the horse.

man (petting butt stallion): can i keep him?

cop: no.

[the horse neighs angrily at the cop]

man: he said yes.

cop (to the sky): is any higher being is watching... please smite me. just... just a light smiting. not even full smite. like, a lightning tingle.

gearbox dev #2: don't worry, you're in the DLC now.

cop: NOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOO-

[CRASH!!!]

[a sonic boom, followed by a meteoric THUD-a human missile slams into the roof of the man's frankenstiened car, bouncing off the hood and rolling into a pile of traffic cones.]

fred randall: I SWEAR IT WASN'T ME!!

[CRASH #2!!!]

[another body crashes down seconds later. It's none other than the grizzled and perpetually irritated astronaut-]

william "wild bill" overbeck: RANDALL, YOU DENSE FOSSIL!! YOU SET THE MARS COURSE TO "MARS, IOWA"!!

fred (looking around): wait... wait a second... There's oxygen here...

bill: and gravity!

fred: ...oh man. we're back on earth, aren't we?

bill: YOU LANDED US ON A TRAFFIC JAM IN NEW JERSEY!!

[just then, the man cheerfully walks over and starts monologuing, eyes wide like he's describing a documentary only he can see.]

man: so first, a cop told me to pull over, but i had a hoodie. then my car stopped, then started, then stopped again when it ran out of go juice. then a tow truck showed up, but i traded it a tire because "tow" sounds like "tire." then Nintendo beat up the cop for copyright, a horse smelled my sandwich, Borderlands came alive, and now-

[BWOOOOOOOSH!!!]

[suddenly, butt stallion and the horse truck are abducted in a tractor beam as UFOs roar above.]

man: woah. i didn't even have to fill out a form for that one.

[as the UFOs vanish over the skyline, a Gearbox dev clutches his forehead in panic.]

gearbox dev #1: how do we keep this from the public now?!

gearbox dev #2: we... we can't.

[ZOOOOM!]

[the man reappears instantly, somehow now carrying the entire Times Square Jumbotron on his back like a glowing, humming backpack. on screen is a chaotic news anchor. none other than Weird Al himself.]

weird al (on screen): "...and in other news, lesbian nazi-hookers abducted by UFOs and forced into weight loss programs..."

man (pointing at screen): what's a nazi? is that the thing that rhymes with ice cream sandwiches?

fred randall: I'm not correcting him.

bill: i gave up trying to understand ten seconds into his first sentence.

[SHOOOOOMP!!]

[a door opens in mid-air-a floating, glowing rectangle like someone cut a portal with a giant invisible scissors. out step the UFO aliens: tall, slimy, wearing tiny business suits.]

alien #1: are you tired of boring earth economies? join the franchise of Rutherford B. Hayes today! includes mustache wax, honorary medals, and a free haunted train station!

alien #2: invest now, and we'll throw in a second Rutherford B. Hayes-absolutely free!

gearbox dev #3: we're ending this. Now.

[the Gearbox devs go full action movie: sunglasses drop down, guitars screech from nowhere, and the devs dive into the aliens with flying kicks and DLC patches.]

alien #3: ow! that's not canon!

gearbox dev #2 (choking alien): neither was Battleborn, but here we are!!

[while chaos erupts again, the man steps into the still-open portal door.]

fred: don't go in there!

man: why not?

bill: that door leads to a multi-dimensional capitalist void powered by presidential beards and failed history teachers.

man: sounds like where i left my socks.

[he disappears into the glowing light. the portal seals with a quiet "pop." silence falls.]

fred: ...i give it 10 seconds before he comes back.

[FLASH!]

[the man reappears instantly, riding a sentient gas pump, now wearing a sash that reads "Miss Rutherford 1880" and holding a box labeled "E-Z bake interdimensional debt kit."]

man: i'm back! i brought soup!

gearbox dev #1 (panting): i need to lay down. In a volcano.

fred: i need to get off this planet.

bill: i need a legal guardian.

[after hours of being tied up, covered in jam, trampled by a horse, and sued by nintendo, the cop finally wriggles free of the stop sign.]

cop (panting, delirious): okay... okay... that's it. that's enough. every time someone says anything, someone shows up.

[he looks around. fred is eating a glow stick, the man is licking a traffic cone like it's a popsicle, and the Gearbox devs are interrogating a knocked-out alien with a Borderlands artbook.]

cop: i'm gonna test this.

he clears his throat dramatically.

cop: bill. gates.

[CRASH!! BOOM! SWOOSH!]

[a secret tunnel opens in the pavement, and a rope ladder slaps onto the ground. out climbs... not Bill Gates, but a sweaty, wild-eyed Benjamin Franklin Gates from National Treasure, holding the actual Declaration of Independence like it's a receipt for tacos.]

ben gates (confused): the treasure's here, right? it all lines up-stop signs, weird traffic, glowing jam. this is it. the final clue. i knew the aliens were involved.

fred randall (gasping): It's Ronald Reagan!

bill overbeck: that's not-

cop (cutting in): it's not Ronald Reagan, that's Benjamin Ga-

[WAAAAAAGHHHHHHHHH-]

[a freight train slams through the scene out of nowhere like it was waiting for this moment. it plows right into the cop mid-sentence, sending him flying

through a stack of folding chairs and a balloon arch labeled "National Treasure Fan Meet-Up."]

train conductor (poking head out): sorry! my GPS got hacked by a talking spatula!

[The train disappears just as fast as it came. everyone watches in stunned silence.]

fred (genuinely impressed): woah. that guy's bones sounded like a xylophone.

ben gates: was that a secret underground train route used by the Freemasons? i need to write this down.

gearbox dev #1: don't even try, man. the last guy who asked questions turned into a cryptocurrency.

[the cop groans from the wreckage, still alive somehow, but now partially covered in glitter and a stuck-on name tag that says "hi my name is: pain."]

cop (wheezing): i'm gonna sue the planet.

man (walking up, holding a lava lamp): you can't sue the planet. i tried once. It told me to get a lawyer from Jupiter. but the flight's delayed.

ben gates (reading the Declaration): the map says "x marks the jam." that must be a metaphor for the horse jam we had earlier.

man (nodding solemnly): i told everyone i love jam. especially when it smells like basketballs.

fred (pulling a spaghetti noodle from his pocket): i still think he's Reagan.

[suddenly, a giant hologram of Whoopi Goldberg appears in the sky for no reason.]

whoopi hologram: the prophecy has begun.

[everyone looks around.]

bill overbeck: okay, I'm gonna go find the nearest moon crater and scream into it.

PART II

judge: order in the court!

[the judge slams his gavel dramatically.]

cop: your honor, i am begging you to lock this man up.

judge: defendant, you stand accused of: reckless driving, evading police, unauthorized tire "trade," persistent smart-alec behavior, and-somehow-verbal vandalism.

man: i don't remember that last one. did i graffiti with words?

cop: yes. You talked for six hours. i think the sidewalk's still offended.

judge: enough. How do you plead?

man: with jazz hands!

[the man does jazz hands. the court reporter slowly removes her glasses in defeat.]

judge: one more outburst and I'll have you held in contempt.

man: oh! i love soup!

judge: ...what?

cop: he thinks "contempt" is a brand of soup.

man: is it spicy?

judge: i've had enough. i sentence you to one year in prison.

man: did you say one year in present!?

[a distant rumble. then, an explosion of bricks as the courtroom skylight is destroyed by a meteor-sized red blur. it lands belly-first with a seismic splat.]

[900 pounds of crimson jolliness slowly rises from the rubble. it's Santa. he's early. and sweaty.]

santa: HO. HO. HO.

judge: what the-

santa: SOMEONE SAID PRESENT.

man: it was me!! hi santa!

santa: you've been... unreasonably consistent. so as per subsection 12-b of the emergency holiday protocol...

[he hoists a weapon that looks like a paintball gun fused with a fire hose. it glistens. it hums. it drips raspberry.]

santa: i present... the JAM GUN.

man: it's beautiful. does it taste like my dreams?

santa: depends. do your dreams taste like raspberry carpet?

man: yes!

judge: this is highly irregular!

santa: you're highly naughty!

[he flips a switch. coal begins raining from the air vents onto the judge's podium. a full charcoal avalanche buries half the desk.]

judge: SECURITY!!

cop: uh, question-what in the actual frozen North Pole are you doing here in September?

santa: oh right. thanks for the reminder.

[he snaps his fingers. he vanishes with a poof, with no evidence of him ever showing up.]

man: yay! i got a jam gun!

[jam starts to spray through the courtroom like raspberry napalm. the walls drip. the jury ducks under their seats. a pigeon outside flies into a window and slides down slowly, coated in fruit spread.]

judge: STOP!! i COMMAND YOU TO CEASE JAMMING!!

man: sorry i can't hear you over the sound of delicious.

[he spins with the jam gun, tagging the ceiling tiles like a deranged waffle artist.]

judge: THAT'S IT! I'm calling 911!

[he yanks a dusty red emergency phone from under his desk and presses the glowing "CALL" button.]

[but before the first ring even finishes-]

[BOOOOOOOOOOOOM]

[a wall explodes open in a cloud of glitter and questionable confetti. standing in the rubble is a grotesque hybrid of a llama's body and the grinning head of Barack Obama. behind him stand two figures in torn monster uniforms, blinking in exhaustion.]

obama bin llama: did someone say... 9-1-1?

[his voice echoes like a bad dub over a worse movie.]

judge: WHAT THE HECK!?

man: cool! a unicorn goat!

obama bin llama: thank you thank you thank you, your call inspired me!! the best idea i've ever had! my terrorist attack will be... on 9-1-1!! THE DATE!! genius, right??

[he claps his hooves like castanets. a trumpet plays from nowhere.]

obama bin llama: i have NO idea what the attack will be. zero. nada. completely blank on the details. but the DATE? pure art.

mike wazowski: please end my suffering.

sully: we were just trying to clock in at monsters inc. now we're part of a llama-themed calendar cult.

obama bin llama: silence, employees of evil! this courtroom is now the new terrorist headquarters! thanks to this wonderful jammy man and his sticky rebellion!

[he trots up to the judge and plants a fat kiss on his forehead. the jam gun sprays upward in surprise and knocks out the ceiling fan.]

obama bin llama: i love you. you are my strawberry soulmate.

judge: get your alpaca lips away from me-

obama bin llama: shhhh... let destiny speak through tongue.

[the llama-head inches closer. glitter sparkles midair. sully begins dry-heaving. mike wazowski quietly weeps jam.]

[but then-]

[ERRRRNNGGGGHHH]

[a deafening screech from an old courtroom loudspeaker mounted crookedly on the wall. it sparks once, then booms with a distorted voice like an angry fax machine.]

???: ENOUGH. STOP THE ROMANCE [BLEEP]!

everyone freezes. even the jam gun sputters in fear.

another voice comes through-sarcastic, lazy, vaguely annoyed.

???: oh great. now we're doing llama weddings. what's next, toaster honeymoons?

???: [BLEEP] YOU, ART.

[the back door slams open with a dramatic whoosh of air and existential dread. the fluorescent lights flicker like they regret being here.]

[standing in the doorway is not a man. not a woman. not even a lifeform by traditional standards.]

[it is... Murderbot.]

[a seven-foot armored nightmare with matte-black plating, a helmet shaped like a war crime, and a weapon the size of a compact car pointed directly at obama bin llama.]

murderbot: step away from the courthouse romance before i introduce your fuzzy digestive system to ballistic compression.

man: yay a new friend! what's your name?

murderbot: i can't tell you that.

obama bin llama: you can't shoot me! this is love!

murderbot: i don't do love. i don't do weddings. i do projectile violence and pretending humans aren't real.

murderbot walks forward slowly, every step causing the jam puddles to ripple like dramatic soup.

sully: i don't want to die next to a llama and a sentient glue stick.

murderbot: that can be arranged.

[the lights suddenly blink out. total darkness. gasps. someone falls over a bench.]

man (cheerfully): oh! night time! goodnight everyone!

[a pause. silence. then-]

[CLICK]

[the lights come back on. but now... no one has moved. no one has left. no one has entered. yet something feels... off.]

[murderbot looks around slowly. everyone is frozen mid-motion. mike is mid-sob. sully is mid-blink. obama is mid-pucker.]

murderbot: ...what the [BLEEP].

[murderbot lowers the gun slightly. not out of peace. out of confusion.]

murderbot (quietly): they didn't even try to run. they just... froze. like badly written background characters.

[murderbot scans the room. no signals. no readings. only jam. so much jam.]

murderbot: i hate humans. i hate jam. i hate surprise kisses. and i hate not understanding the [BLEEP] going on.

[the jam gun drips once. slowly. then the lights shut off again.]

man (still thinking it's bedtime): goodnight toaster. goodnight obama.
goodnight death guy. goodnight frog that lives in my hat.

[the lights are back on again. murderbot is gone. jam still drips from the
judge's bench like raspberry regret.]

[the cop, trembling, takes slow, careful steps toward the exit door, clutching
what's left of his dignity in one hand and a pocketful of anti-anxiety mints in
the other.]

cop (whispering): just a few more steps... and maybe i can pretend this day
was a fever dream...

[his hand reaches the door handle. click.]

???: COURT. IS. NOT. OVER.

[the judge is somehow behind him. no footsteps. no sound. just suddenly
there, looming with wild eyes and coal dust still stuck in his collar.]

cop: GYAAH!

judge: BACK. TO. THE. BENCH.

[the cop stumbles back inside like a guilty raccoon. the courtroom feels more
cursed now. or maybe just jam-stained beyond repair.]

[but now... in the place where murderbot stood before...]

[stands a new figure.]

[a massive, brownish-gray bearded man with a light blue shirt, dark blue
pants, and brown shoes. he looks exactly like jack black, but with the
confused energy of someone who thinks he's in line for frozen yogurt.]

cop: ...who the [BLEEP] are you?

man: language! there are kids reading this story!

jack-black-looking-guy: i... am steve.

[ZAP! ZZZZT! BZZZRK!]

[he's tased on the spot by four lawyers in red ties vaulting over the railing like angry gymnasts. one of them yells mid-air.]

nintendo lawyer #1: UNLICENSED CHARACTER USAGE!

nintendo lawyer #2: VIOLATION OF BEDROCK MARKETPLACE TERMS!

nintendo lawyer #3: THIS IS A MINECRAFT MOVIE YEAR, BABY!!

[they tase him again for good measure. he lets out a dramatic scream that sounds exactly like the "Wilhelm Scream" mixed with a kazoo.]

man: oh hey! is this a sock moment?

[he pulls two ancient, dirt-stained socks from his hoodie pocket. one has a hole, the other smells like disappointment.]

man: introducing... left foot larry and stinktooth sue!

[he puts the socks on his hands and begins a full-blown puppet show. complete with voices.]

left foot larry (high voice): i object to your jam logic!

stinktooth sue (deep gravelly voice): i object to your objection!

man: gasp! a court battle!

[he slams his sock-hands together dramatically. a nearby bailiff weeps silently.]

[six hours later...]

[the courtroom has devolved into a tornado of yelling, stomping, cease-and-desist forms, and the faint sound of someone slapping a ukulele repeatedly.]

judge: YOU CAN'T COPYRIGHT A NAME USED BY AN ACCIDENTAL LLAMA!

cop: MY LEGS ARE STUCK TO THE FLOOR WITH JAM!

nintendo lawyer #4: WE'LL COPYRIGHT THE AIR IF WE HAVE TO!

man: ...does anyone else hear toast?

[he is still puppeting. he has no idea what's going on. hasn't for hours.]

stinktooth sue: objection! you're toast-intolerant!

left foot larry: i rest my crumbs!

[mike wazowski has fallen asleep on the jam gun. sully is muttering to a plant. obama bin llama is writing vows on a napkin.]

[then it happens.]

bystander #1 (to their brother in the gallery): hey mario, pass me that water bottle-

nintendo lawyer #1: ...what did you just say?

bystander #1: uh... my brother. his name's-

nintendo lawyers (in unison): MARIO!?

[they all reach under the bench. flamethrowers emerge. bright red. n-shaped.]

nintendo lawyer #3: COPYRIGHT FIRE CLEANS ALL.

[flames ignite. jam begins to bubble. ceiling tiles melt. the courtroom screams.]

man (still socking): i think the spaghetti is angry!

left foot larry: THIS IS THE END TIMES.

stinktooth sue: we ride at dawn!

cop (melting slightly): i KNEW i SHOULD'VE BEEN A LIBRARIAN.

judge: SOMEONE SAY LUIGI AND i SWEAR TO THE SUPREME COURT-

[tap tap]

[a hand taps his shoulder. the judge freezes mid-rant.]

[slowly... he turns around.]

[standing there is a man in a bright orange prison jumpsuit. no cuffs. no chains. just pure freedom and a grin that could slice glass. it is...]

[luigi mangione . escaped convict. forbidden name.]

[he does not speak. not one syllable.]

[he reaches into his pocket and pulls out a small, simple white mask. slips it on. tilts his head.]

[he is now... a mime.]

[and somehow... impossibly... everything stops.]

[the lawyers freeze mid-flame.]

[the judge lowers his gavel mid-scream.]

[the man pauses mid-sock monologue.]

[the jam gun sighs into silence.]

[even obama bin llama blinks slowly, entranced.]

[mime luigi pantomimes pulling a rope. then climbing a ladder. then entering an invisible box.]

[the room is hypnotized. silent. mesmerized.]

[mime luigi bows. conjures fake flowers. cries fake tears. makes a balloon out of literal silence. sully claps quietly.]

[the man drops his socks to the ground like they're holy.]

man (whispers): that spaghetti just told a whole story.

[even the nintendo lawyers are seated, politely watching, one of them sipping imaginary tea.]

[forty-five minutes pass. not a word. not a breath louder than reverence.]

[and then...]

mime luigi (removing mask, quietly): thank you for watching my performance.

[instant chaos resumes.]

judge: COPYRIGHT LAWS SUCK!!

nintendo lawyer #1: YOU OWE US FOR THAT FLOWER BIT!

cop: HE MADE A BALLOON OUT OF NOTHING!!

man (picking up his socks again): larry, you missed it. he was like a jam ghost but without goo.

left foot larry: i had no mouth and i screamed art!

stinktooth sue: mime crimes are the most polite crimes.

the jam gun starts hissing again. someone hits mike with a chair. obama bin llama proposes to a painting.

mime luigi bows once more... then moonwalks backward into a smoke cloud and vanishes. no doors. no exit. just poof.

[the chaos resumes like it never stopped.]

cop (sobbing): was that real?

judge: IT WAS A PERFORMANCE OF ILLEGAL THEATRICALS! WE'LL SUE HIS SHADOW!

man (happily jamming): this is my favorite episode of Space Jam.

cop (ducking under a table): this isn't even a legal proceeding anymore!!

judge: IT IS IF I SAY SO!!

[BOOOOOOOOOM]

[the main doors BURST open. several heavily armed men in black body armor labeled I.C.E. stomp into the room like a SWAT team lost on their way to basic literacy.]

[they aim rifles at everyone. the chaos halts. jam drips in silence.]

lead ice agent: what in the unconstitutional fruit salad is going on in here!?

ice agent #2: and why isn't that man even involved!?

[he points at the man, who's currently putting tiny paper hats on his sock puppets.]

man: oops! i forgot to argue!

[he stands up dramatically, flinging a sock into the air. it lands on the cop]

man: i would like to make the following case: ICE agents are frauds because their body temperature isn't even under 32 degrees fahrenheit.

cop (facepalming): oh my lord.

lead ice agent: how dare you insult our acronym!

[the lead ICE agent steps forward, revealing his face-]

[it is Donald Trump. glowing slightly orange. hair defying physics. eyes squinting with chaotic authority.]

donald: i will arrest ALL of you. even the judge. if ONE MORE WORD comes out of anyone's mouth about jam, copyright, socks, or ANYTHING STUPID-

[BLAM!]

[a gunshot echoes. donald trump's eyes widen in shock. he falls forward in slow motion.]

[standing behind him, perfectly preserved in youth, clean-shaven and grinning, is Walt Disney. back from the dead. not a wrinkle in sight. his suit is flawless. his aura smells like vintage capitalism.]

walt disney: sorry, but "donald" is copyrighted. should've changed it in 1987.

[ZWHIP!]

[a sniper bullet tears through disney's skull mid-word. he crumples silently.]

[up in the balcony stands nintendo lawyer #1, holding a glowing legal sniper rifle. the barrel reads: "INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY: EXTREME EDITION."]

nintendo lawyer #1: YOU MESS WITH THE MOUSE, YOU GET THE CLAWS.

[BLAM-BLAM!]

[a loud crack echoes. luigi mangione is BACK. he's holding a real gun now. mime mask around his neck. orange jumpsuit still fresh. he fires twice. nintendo lawyer #1 drops instantly.]

cop: WHAT IS HAPPENING.

[PEW-PEW]

[luigi mangione takes two steps-]

[-before a blaster bolt zaps through his back. he gasps, turns-]

[it's Donald Trump. somehow alive again. holding a golden laser pistol labeled "PATRIOT EDITION."]

donald: you're fired.

[luigi falls. again. everyone freezes. again.]

[a low hum builds in the air. the walls vibrate. jam drips upward. socks float slightly.]

judge: ...oh no.

cop: we just broke cause and effect.

man: is this time pasta?

[the bodies of disney, trump, luigi, and the lawyer begin twitching... blinking... fading in and out like a broken gif.]

[the clock on the wall starts spinning counterclockwise. then sideways. then it turns into a waffle and explodes.]

[everyone starts aging backwards, then forward, then sideways. one guy turns into a baby with a mustache. sully becomes a pile of tickets. mike duplicates.]

mike wazowski #1: i hate this.

mike wazowski #2: why do i have to see myself suffer?

[the courtroom dissolves into paradox. jam rains upward. socks speak latin. obama bin llama is now a toaster.]

man (laughing): spaghetti is time!

judge (screaming into nothing): REWIND THE UNIVERSE! i ORDER A MISTRIAL ON EXISTENCE!!

[time reverses.]

[not quickly. not cleanly. like someone hit rewind on a broken microwave full of jelly.]

[people age in reverse, jam drips upward, the assassinations un-happen, copyright flames rewind into sparks, luigi mangione re-mimes, and the courtroom reassembles piece by piece like a guilt-ridden lego set.]

[lights flicker. the jam gun un-fires. trump unsays everything. disney re-undies himself. time hiccups... and resets...]

[we are back...]

[at the beginning.]

[just the man. the cop. and the judge. in the courtroom. alone.]

judge: court is now in session. state vs-what was it again?

cop: the human spaghetti noodle with a license.

man: i like jam.

[but before anything else happens...]

[POP. POP. POP.]

[three exact duplicates appear in the middle of the courtroom: man #2, cop #2, and judge #2 - slightly more twitchy, clearly from the "future," and covered in faint jam residue.]

cop: what the-

cop #2: oh great. this part again.

judge: WHO ARE YOU!?

judge #2: I'M YOU WITH TRAUMA.

man: hey! me!

man #2: hey! me!

[they fist bump and their combined brainpower cancels gravity for 0.2 seconds. a pencil floats. then drops.]

man: do you like jam?

man #2: do tacos cry when you eat them?

man: ...yes.

man #2: then yes.

[they instantly begin a game of rock, paper, jam.]

man: jam!

man #2: jam!

man & man #2: tie again!

[they continue playing. it keeps tying. every time. somehow they keep throwing literal jam.]

cop: how is this happening!?

cop #2: YOU TRIED TO LEAVE AND ICE SHOWED UP.

judge: we are NOT doing time doubles today!

judge #2: oh we're doing ALL of it.

[SWOOSH]

[a flash of light. Nicolas Cage enters from behind a curtain that wasn't there before. he's wearing a pinstripe suit made of old court transcripts and sunglasses that scream confusion.]

nicolas cage: your honor.

judge and judge #2: which one?

nicolas cage: yes.

[nicolas cage pulls a scroll from his jacket that smells like mothballs and regret.]

nicolas cage: there's someone with an urgent message for you. they're right outside. may i bring them-

[SLAM!!!]

[before he finishes, the courtroom doors are OBLITERATED by a large feathered missile.]

[an ostrich bursts into the room. no saddle. no rider. just fury. and legs that don't quit.]

judge: oh great. let me guess. the sky is falling?

ostrich (deadpan): no.

[a shadow passes overhead. everyone looks up.]

[a moon. not the moon. but a moon. small, golf-cart sized, but unmistakably moon-shaped.]

[it crashes through the ceiling like a celestial bowling ball.]

[CRUNCH. BOOM. SQUISH.]

[it lands directly on the original judge.]

[silence.]

man: that moon just judged the judge.

man #2: poetic

cop: is he... dead?

cop #2: define "dead."

nicolas cage: this happens every thursday.

ostrich: i told him it wasn't the sky.

man (offering jam to ostrich): want to play rock paper jam?

ostrich: only if we tie forever.

PART III

[the prison gates open with a groan like a depressed whale.]

man: ooooh this hotel looks spicy.

cop: it's prison.

man (whispering): fancy hotel with bars. got it.

[a guard frisks the man. he giggles like it tickles.]

cop (to guard): don't bother. he's got nothing but three crayons and a crouton.

guard (confused): how's the crouton still warm?

man: i loved it till it loved me back.

cop: i'm done. officially done. i drop him off. i walk away. and i never, ever think about this fruit salad of a human again.

[the cop turns dramatically. his phone rings. he answers without looking.]

cop: what.

voice (deep, echoing): this is big louie.

cop: oh no.

big louie: congratulations. your new assignment is to supervise inmate no. 1337.

cop: i don't want it.

big louie: too bad. it's you. only you. all day. every day.

cop: i hate you.

big louie: i hate me too. click

man (from his cell): hi roommate!

cop: i'm not your roommate.

man: do you want to braid my leg hair?

cop: no. stop. be normal.

[the man turns to a nearby inmate. big guy. lots of tattoos. probably eats smaller inmates as snacks.]

man: hey do you like jam

tattooed inmate: what

cop: SHUSH. do not talk. no friends. no jam gangs. no undercover crime groups.

man: okay.

[four hours pass.]

cop (suspiciously): why haven't you spoken.

man (softly): i'm thinking.

cop: about what.

man: taxes. and also squirrels.

cop stares.

[the man turns to the back of his cell.]

[his eyes sparkle.]

man: oh look! it's gold!

cop: what.

man: like a lot of gold.

cop: what.

man: a big pile. right here. in my cell.

[the cop rushes over, squints into the shadows. sure enough. massive glittering heap of gold bricks stacked like golden legos.]

cop: WHERE DID THIS COME FROM

man: from time.

cop: what.

man: because time is gold.

cop: that's not a saying!!

man: it is now. and also... it looks like at least... hmm...

[he counts on his fingers. two of which are jam-sticky.]

man: five million dollars.

cop: no. you can't just guess it's five million-

[CLANG.]

[the cell door opens.]

guard: he's free to go.

cop: WHAT.

guard: bail posted. five million exactly. weirdest wire transfer i've ever seen.
had raspberry stains on it.

cop: HOW.

man (already walking out): bye cell! i'm off to rescue my friends and spread
fruit-based joy.

cop: you're not rescuing anyone!

man (turns dramatically): i'll be right back.

cop: what are you planning-

[FWOOOOSH]

[the man exits. 1.8 seconds pass.]

[CRASH.]

[he returns, carrying the entire Times Square Jumbotron.]

cop: HOW.

man: it followed me home! again!

[he presses a big glowing button labeled "BIG BUTTON" and the screen
buzzes to life.]

tv voice: welcome to late-night television... but, like, in the middle of the
afternoon...

[the man starts swiping channels. the remote is just a cardboard box with shirt buttons attached. first channel: news channel 8.]

anchor (panicking): breaking news-someone has stolen the entire Times Square Jumbotron. again. somehow. authorities are baffled, confused, and emotionally exhausted.

cop: wait. isn't that the thing you're... watching right now?

man: shhhh they're talking about me on TV. i'm a celebrity.

[he swipes to the second channel, a snail race.]

announcer #1: and they're off!!

announcer #2: geraldine takes the lead-wait no she stopped for a nap.

announcer #1: harold just moved a whole inch! this is neck-and-neck... if they had necks.

random prisoner: i bet twenty on harold.

man: this is the best day of my life.

cop: you stole a national monument and you're using it as a glorified living room.

man: shhh.

[he swipes again.]

third channel (a commercial from ICE): DO YOU KNOW AN ILLEGAL ALIEN? want FIVE THOUSAND DOLLARS?? hand-deliver one to your local ICE facility today! offer valid until the federal government collapses again.

[the screen shows smiling ICE agents handing money to a cartoon eagle. the eagle salutes, then explodes into a flag.]

man (squinting): hmm...

[he scratches his chin with a breadstick he found in his pocket.]

man: i remember these guys. i made fun of them for not being 32 degrees.

cop: please don't do anything. please just sit down and watch the snails like a normal prisoner.

man: never.

[he power-walks toward the exit.]

cop: WHERE ARE YOU GOING

man: i'm gonna get paid for patriotism.

[just before he reaches the door...]

[a woman blocks his path.]

lady: hello. i no speako english. only el spanisho.

man: ...wait a second.

[he narrows his eyes. turns slowly. picks up the lady by her armpits.]

man: you smell... suspiciously like plot device.

lady: what?

man (gasps): YOU'RE A SPANISH SPEAKER.

lady: uh, yeah?

man: ICE PAYS FOR SPANISH SPEAKERS!!

cop: THAT'S NOT WHAT THEY MEANT

man (ignores): into the wallet you go!

[he unfolds his wallet and stuffs the lady in like she's a rare sticker.]

cop: YOU CAN'T STUFF PEOPLE INTO WALLETS

man: i can if it's for five grand.

cop: that's not how ICE works.

man: that's not how i work.

[he proudly raises the bulging wallet.]

man: i'm gonna be RICH!!

[from the TV, the snail announcer yells.]

announcer: harold just blinked!! THE CROWD GOES MILD!!

man (to TV): i'll be back for the finale!

[the man kicks open the prison exit like it owes him lunch money. in front of him stand four sharply dressed figures in suits, holding briefcases made of litigation and pure evil.]

nintendo lawyer #1: well well well.

nintendo lawyer #2: if it isn't the human lawsuit.

nintendo lawyer #3: we heard someone stuffed a person... into a small container.

nintendo lawyer #4: that, sir, is a copyright violation of the Pokémon franchise.

man (nervously): i called it a wallet though.

nintendo lawyer #1: doesn't matter. the act of object containment is ours.
you're now legally entangled in-

[they squint. pause. sniff the air.]

nintendo lawyer #3 (recognizing): wait a second...

nintendo lawyer #4: isn't this the guy from the traffic jam incident?

nintendo lawyer #2: oh. right. he's too dumb to sue.

nintendo lawyer #1: court records show he legally qualifies as a foghorn in three states.

nintendo lawyer #4: we almost lost a trademark just trying to read his thoughts.

man: i once forgot my name for four days and called myself "baguette hands."

cop (dead inside): every word you say is a war crime in sentence form.

nintendo lawyer #1: alright. we're done here. let's go.

[they turn to leave. then, across the prison courtyard, someone shouts.]

prisoner voice (from inside): hey! someone found the light switch to the cafeteria!!

[everything goes silent. the nintendo lawyers freeze mid-step.]

nintendo lawyer #2: ...did someone say...

nintendo lawyer #3: ...switch?

[they all turn. their necks crack like angry vinyl.]

nintendo lawyer #4: NO ONE SAYS THAT WORD.

[they all scream in unison.]

nintendo lawyers: NINTENDO OWNS "SWITCH"!

[they burst past the man and cop like rage-powered FBI agents with copyright warrants in their pockets and cease-and-desist in their hearts.]

man: ooooh, this just got spicy.

cop (rubbing his eyes): we don't even have a cafeteria.

man: we do now.

[they follow the sounds of angry stomping and lawsuit-paper rustling. inside the cafeteria, dim lights flicker. trays are flipped. there's a mild smell of old corn dogs and forgotten macaroni.]

nintendo lawyer #1: WHERE IS THE SWITCHER.

[a voice from above.]

prisoner: up here! i'm stuck!

[they look up.]

[there, chained to the ceiling by ankles, spinning slowly like a sad disco ball, is a man with thick curly hair and a confused smile.]

ceiling prisoner (Arabian accent): please, friends. i have been here three weeks. my foot finally reached the switch. can someone help me down?

nintendo lawyer #2: HE SAID IT AGAIN!!

[they begin rolling up their sleeves, ready to sue. but then-]

[SLAM]

[the cafeteria door is kicked open again. this time it's four sharp-dressed individuals in mouse-ear hats and pajamas laced with smiley faces.]

disney lawyer #1: THAT ACCENT IS COPYRIGHTED.

disney lawyer #2: YOU THINK YOU CAN JUST SOUND ARABIAN WITHOUT PAYING DISNEY?

disney lawyer #3: WE OWN "ALADDIN," "THE DESERT," AND SAND.

anakin skywalker (on the jumbotron): i hate sand.

disney lawyer #4 (pulling gun): THIS IS IP WAR, BABY.

nintendo lawyer #3: YOU WANNA START THIS?

disney lawyer #1: WE ALREADY STARTED WHEN WE BOUGHT PIXAR.

nintendo lawyer #2: THAT WAS OUR EMOTIONAL PROPERTY!!

[BATTLE ENSUES]

[flamethrowers roar from the hands of nintendo lawyers, their red ties flapping like battle flags. missile launchers are now strapped to the backs of disney lawyers, who reload them with magical lawsuits shaped like candy canes and war crimes.]

[BOOM!]

[a missile explodes against a pudding cart. pudding screams. pudding dies.]

[FWOOOOSH]

[a flamethrower roasts a lunch tray. it melts. screams in metal.]

ceiling prisoner (still spinning): is it weird that i'm getting hungry?

[the man sits down on a melted bench, holding a jam container that wasn't there before.]

man: this is better than reality TV.

cop (sits next to him, sighing): this is reality.

[prisoners begin to gather around. some bring folding chairs. one guy has a stolen ice cream machine from McDonald's for some reason.]

cop (remembering): wait. wait wait wait.

[he checks his phone.]

cop: Big Louie says i still have to watch you.

man: but i'm not a prisoner anymore.

cop: doesn't matter. i'm stuck to you like expired glue in a legal fever dream.

man (grinning): friendship!

cop: surveillance.

man: same thing.

[the battle continues for twenty long minutes.]

[missiles fly. flames lick the walls. one nintendo lawyer tries to sue a beam of light. it doesn't work. he gets sued by the beam instead.]

disney lawyer #3 (panting): we're losing. THEY'RE SPAMMING FIRE DAMAGE!

nintendo lawyer #2 (laughing): it's not abuse if it's nostalgia-themed.

[as disney lawyer #3 prepares to surrender using a napkin as a white flag,
disney lawyer #1 grabs his radio.]

disney lawyer #1: this is team mouse ears. we need backup.

[RRRRRRRIIIIIIPPPPPP]

[the ceiling tears off the prison.]

[not downward, but upward. as if the sky sucked it away in a divine vacuum.
prisoners scream. trays float. pudding orbits. gravity flips. everyone screams
as they are launched upward into the sky like meat-flavored balloons.]

cop: WHAT DID HE SAY!?

man (cheerfully): i think he said "back up."

cop: YOU DON'T SAY THAT WORD IN THIS UNIVERSE.

man: jam-ment day has arrived!

cop (spinning midair): WHAT!?

man (arms wide): the day where jam decides what's real and what's toaster!

cop: YOU'RE JUST MAKING THINGS UP.

man: i'm making things legitimate.

cop (shouting at the heavens): HE SAID "BACK UP," YOU IDIOT
NARRATOR! HE DIDN'T MEAN LITERALLY "BACK UP!"

[and just like that-]

[SCHLORP]

[gravity flips back.]

[SLAM. SLAM. WHUMP. BONK.]

[everyone crashes back to the floor like spaghetti trying to do ballet.]

man (unharmd): i landed on pudding. again!

cop (groaning): i landed on the law. and it suplexed me.

[the cafeteria is destroyed. ceilings gone. walls cracked. the courtyard outside looks like a blender threw up prison bricks and confused flowers. a pigeon floats down with a spoon. lands. leaves. ceiling prisoner is now on the floor, somehow still spinning.]

ceiling prisoner (dizzy): i don't like jam anymore.

[the cop stands up, eyes bloodshot, hair sideways, sanity twitching.]

cop: just once. just ONCE. can we not break the universe over a pun?

man (quietly, reverently): today... the world jammed back.

cop: that's not a phrase.

man: it is now.

[the sky begins to rumble. above them hangs a massive, gray sphere with an equatorial dent, many times the size of the moon.]

man (awestruck): it's like a moon... but angry.

cop (horrified): ...that's no moon.

disney lawyer #1: shut up obi-wan.

grand moff tarkin: you may fire when ready.

[he stands calmly at the controls, cape fluttering like it's auditioning for an oscar.]

[but then, in the corner, an old man in a worn-down wheelchair creaks forward.]

great grand moff tarkin: EH? WHAT'D YOU SAY, BOY?

grand moff tarkin (annoyed): I SAID FIRE WHEN READY, DAD.

great grand moff tarkin: WHY ARE YOU YELLING? I'M NOT DEAF I'M JUST OLD.

darth vader (awkward): huff

[the control room falls silent.]

[great grand moff tarkin slowly raises one trembling finger.]

great grand moff tarkin: ...okie dokie.

[on Earth, panic has reached full shrimp mode. guards, inmates, kitchen staff, and a raccoon in a hat, all running in every direction. legally, no one is allowed to leave. emotionally, no one is even real anymore.]

[within 90 seconds, the only things left behind: the man, the cop, the four nintendo lawyers, the four disney lawyers, the Times Square Jumbotron, still somehow playing reruns of Iron Chef Junior, and whatever used to be a prison.]

cop (panting): they all ran...

man: even the ceiling ran away.

nintendo lawyer #3 (shaking): we have no x-wings. no y-wings. no z-wings. no legal wings of any kind.

cop: wait. wait wait wait. this can't be how it ends.

man: then hug me.

disney lawyer #4 (smiling): backup arrived.

disney lawyer #1 (whispers): long live the mouse.

[the jumbotron flashes a brief headline.]

"BREAKING: DEATH STAR CONTRACTED BY DISNEY FOR
EMERGENCY COPYRIGHT ENFORCEMENT"

[then-]

[RRRRRRROOOOOAAAAAARRRRRRR]

[an A-10 thunderbolt screeches through the sky, starting its aggressive climb.]

[it does not stop. it does not blink. it does not care about atmospheric physics.
inside the cockpit, tom hanks tightens his oxygen mask.]

tom hanks (calmly): control, this is hanks-actual. i think someone
accidentally left the game on easy mode.

control (static): uh, roger that?

tom hanks: going to fix that. permanently.

[he flicks a switch labeled "ludicrous speed" and accelerates.]

[eventually, the A-10 breaches the atmosphere like a bullet flying through
paper. the vacuum of space tries to stop it and fails. hanks does not need
oxygen. the A-10 does not need physics. only revenge.]

disney lawyer #1: um. sir. there's a problem.

great grand moff tarkin (half-asleep): is it arthritis again?

disney lawyer #2: no. it's a plane.

grand moff tarkin: a what!?

[they rush to the main window just in time to see a screaming metal warthog hauling absolute freedom through space.]

darth vader (gesturing): do something, you fools!

stormtrooper #77 (at the turret): we got this!

[they open fire, but miss every single time. one shot hits a vending machine in a hallway.]

vader (growling): WHO DESIGNED THESE TURRETS!?

grand moff tarkin: stormtroopers, sir!

vader: of course they did.

[the turrets keep firing. the A-10 barrel rolls like it's auditioning for Top Gun: Galactic Edition. but nothing hits.]

great grand moff tarkin (panicking): FIRE THE MAIN LASER.

[the Death Star begins charging again. green energy swirls like evil laughter.]

[ZWWWWWWWWNNNNNNNNNNNNNNN-BLAAAM!!!]

[the main planet-destroying laser fires, and hits the A-10 directly. but no damage. the A-10 is still there.]

disney lawyer #3: um... it's still there.

grand moff tarkin: WHAT IS THAT PLANE MADE OF!?

stormtrooper #139: plot armor.

darth vader (whispers): i respect that.

[with no turrets working, no more planet lasers, and all their TIE fighters on lunch break, the Death Star is... defenseless.]

great grand moff tarkin: CLOSE. THE. EXHAUST PORTS!!

stormtrooper #61: sir... they don't close.

great grand moff tarkin: WHO BUILT THIS THING!?

stormtrooper #61: a college intern named kevin.

great grand moff tarkin: i HATE KEVIN.

[the A-10 lines up its shot. hanks flips the final switch labeled: "FIRE."]

[BRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRT]

[a single laser bolt, fired with energy, rips forward and plunges right into the main cannon housing, straight to the reactor core.]

grand moff tarkin: ...how did we never think of that?

great grand moff tarkin: i was too old for this job anyway...

[KABOOOOOOOOOOM]

[the Death Star explodes like it just read its own bad reviews. pieces fly everywhere as the A-10 returns to Earth.]

man (standing among ruins, ash, and a jumbotron playing a weather channel from 1996): i guess this is what happens when you take a death star to an A-10 fight.

PART IV

man: this is nice. fresh air. birds. unpaid labor.

cop: it's called community service.

man (nodding): community... like friendship. service... like dinner.

cop: no. like punishment.

man (holding a trash picker): same thing.

[he stabs at a soda can, misses, stabs again, accidentally spears the ground and salutes.]

cop (checking clipboard): you've been here exactly one hour and twelve seconds.

man: time flies when you're fighting dirt.

cop: you're not fighting dirt, you're cleaning it.

man (whispering): the dirt knows what it did.

[a pigeon walks by, side-eyeing the man. the pigeon looks like it's seen too much.]

cop: keep working. big louie says if you finish early, i can finally go home.

man (squinting): i thought you were home.

cop: this job is my home. and you're the leaky faucet that never stops screaming.

[the man bends down to pick up another can, but instead, under a pile of leaves, there's a small, old-fashioned radio. it hums faintly.]

man (gasps): treasure.

cop: that's litter.

man: same thing but with a soundtrack.

[he turns the dial. static crackles. a soft, familiar pop song leaks out, the kind of tune you hear in dentist offices and nightmares.]

cop (instantly): turn that off.

man: why? it's catchy.

cop: it's copyrighted.

man (offended): how can a sound be copyrighted?

cop: that's... literally the foundation of copyright law.

man: not for long.

[he twists the knob again, raising the pitch slightly. the song speeds up. the singer now sounds like helium on espresso.]

cop: what did you do.

man: i fixed it. now it's "fair use."

cop: that's not how-

[there's a tiny pop.]

[the grass rustles. the air smells faintly of acorns and chaos.]

[three tiny figures materialize beside the radio.]

alvin (crossing tiny arms): oh, so this is the clown who stole our song.

simon: blatant theft.

theodore (holding a calculator for no reason): with compound interest, this is-

alvin (interrupting): one dollar.

cop (blinking): one dollar?

alvin: yeah, we're not reasonable. we're small, but very greedy.

man: wow.

[he reaches into his pocket, pulls out... something. it's unclear if it's a coin or a stale crouton.]

theodore (sniffs): is that legal tender?

cop: no, it's bread.

man: bread is tender if you believe in gluten.

[the chipmunks stare. long, disappointed silence.]

simon: we're suing anyway.

[alvin pulls out a microscopic lawsuit scroll. it unrolls, stretches halfway across the park, and smacks the cop in the leg.]

cop (reading): "defendant: weird man. damages: one dollar. emotional harm: incalculable."

man (smiling): i'll pay.

[he drops a dollar coin. it hits the ground like a meteor in slow motion. the chipmunks cheer, grab it, and nearly get flattened under its weight.]

alvin (panting): we're rich! we can buy... half a peanut!

[they wobble away into the bushes, singing their exit theme in an off-key major chord.]

cop: i can't believe that just happened.

man (dusting off his hands): i can.

[he looks proud, like someone who just solved world hunger by gluing bread together.]

cop: don't touch that radio again.

man: but what if i fix it again.

cop: you don't fix things. you turn them into legal problems with feet.

man (thinking): what if i go the opposite direction.

cop: don't.

[the man lowers the pitch on the dial. the music slows down until it sounds like a whale singing karaoke underwater.]

[the ground vibrates. puddles ripple. the pigeons all look up like extras in a disaster movie.]

cop (nervous): what did you-

[the pond at the edge of the park erupts like a cheap fountain show. water sprays everywhere.]

[a massive shape rises from the depths. several massive shapes. whales. four of them. all wearing sunglasses. one has a tie.]

[the biggest one speaks with the voice of thunder and jazz.]

zack the whale: who dares steal our bassline.

man (pointing at the radio): it was... um... that thing.

cop: no. it was you.

zack: we are zack and the whales. copyright guardians of the deep.

smaller whale: and you, land criminal, have committed sonic plagiarism.

man: but i only lowered the pitch!

zack (booming): that's our whole brand.

cop (to himself): of course it is.

zack: for this crime, we demand twenty tons of fish.

man (sweating pepperoni): uh oh.

cop: you think?!

zack (booming): pay or be sued under the oceanic copyright act, subsection "gulp."

man (whispering): do we... even have fish?

cop: no, we don't have fish. we barely have sanity.

smaller whale: then perhaps we'll take your souls.

cop: i don't think i have one left.

man (panicking): ok ok ok, think brain think!

[his eyes dart around. trash bags, pigeons, a squirrel carrying what might be a hotdog, a radio smoldering faintly. no fish anywhere.]

man (snaps fingers): wait. wait wait wait.

cop: what?

man: what day is it?

cop: saturday.

man: no, like... spiritually.

cop: ...what?

man (gasping): it's opposite day.

cop: no it isn't.

man: that's what someone who doesn't believe in opposite day would say on opposite day.

cop: that sentence gave me a migraine.

zack (suspicious): what is "opposite day."

man (dramatic, pointing at sky): it's the one day a year where everything is backwards. up is down, left is right, xenon's a solid, aliens are real, and copyright is copywrong.

cop: please stop making new laws of physics.

man: if it's opposite day, then technically, we don't owe you fish. you owe us fish!

[the whales stare. silence except for the faint sound of the radio wheezing its dying breath.]

zack (sneezing): lies.

smaller whale: oceanic nonsense.

cop (whispering): this isn't going to work.

man (confidently): it always works.

[he points across the park.]

man: behold! proof!

[the whales turn. across the park, a jogger runs past-except, somehow, she's jogging upside down. shoes tapping the air, ponytail dangling toward the sky, completely normal expression.]

cop (blinking): how-

[then a dog trots by, leash holding its owner like a balloon.]

[a delivery truck drives backward. the letters on its side read "spu."]

[zack's jaw drops.]

zack: the surface world... has gone mad.

smaller whale (panicking): sir! the gravity laws are rebelling again!

zack (sweating seawater): impossible.

cop (deadpan): welcome to my life.

[zack looks down at the man, who's now striking a proud superhero pose despite holding a trash picker and a half-melted popsicle.]

man: so. as per opposite day regulation 4 subsection "your mother," you now owe us twenty tons of fish.

zack (reluctantly): ...fine.

cop (startled): wait, what?!

[zack sighs, turning toward the sky as if calling customer service.]

zack: hey, narrator? execute clause “massive seafood debt repayment.”

cop: don’t.

man: do.

[the air grows heavy. clouds roll in fast, dark and bloated like overcooked marshmallows. thunder rumbles-except it’s not thunder. it’s gurgling.]

cop: is the sky bubbling?

man (squints): that’s either a weather event or someone boiling soup.

zack: stand back. the fish will arrive shortly.

smaller whale (to zack): should we warn them?

zack: nah. surface folks love surprises.

[and then-]

[SPLAT]

[a single trout lands next to the man’s shoe.]

man: ...hello, destiny.

[SPLAT. SPLAT. SPLAT.]

[dozens more. hundreds.]

[then the heavens open up.]

[fish rain from the sky in glorious, slippery abundance. salmon, tuna, sardines, swordfish, goldfish, confused jellyfish who clearly didn’t sign up for this.]

cop: oh come on.

man (arms wide): hallelujah!

[a mackerel slaps him across the face. he smiles anyway.]

[cop holds his hat down as a wave of anchovies pelts him like angry raindrops.]

cop: i didn't go to law enforcement school for this.

man: you went to law enforcement school?

cop: twice!

[a twenty-pound grouper bounces off his shoulder.]

cop: this is a workplace hazard!

man (gleeful): it's opposite day, so it's a workplace miracle!

[fish pile up across the park, slippery mountains of scales and regret. joggers-turned-upside-down now try to shield themselves with gym bags. pigeons cheer and dive-bomb the buffet.]

cop (slipping): i can't see! i'm drowning in cod!

man (surfing a tuna): cowabunga, officer!

cop: that's not even the right ocean!

[a swordfish impales a park bench like it's auditioning for broadway.]

[a child in the distance yells, "mommy, it's seafood christmas!" before being gently buried under shrimp.]

zack (sighing): debt repaid.

smaller whale: technically we overpaid by a few buckets.

zack: keep the change.

[they begin to sink back toward the ocean skywardly, because logic gave up five minutes ago.]

cop: i swear, if another living thing shows up to sue us, i'm moving to the moon.

man (cheerfully): you might wanna stay here for a few more minutes.

cop: why-

[a deep, luxurious engine rev echoes across the park. tires screech. fish scatter.]

[a black suv slides into view, perfectly clean despite the surrounding seafood apocalypse. the license plate reads pixlaw1.]

[the doors open in cinematic unison. four figures step out, all wearing perfectly clean suits, each holding briefcases that hum with expensive confidence.]

pixar lawyer #1: good afternoon.

cop: no.

pixar lawyer #2 (adjusting sunglasses): yes.

man (giddy): new friends!

cop (gritting teeth): not friends. predators.

pixar lawyer #3: we represent disney subsidiary pixar studios, protectors of emotion, fish, and sentient automobiles.

man (confused): sounds like a dating profile.

pixar lawyer #4: we've received reports of unsanctioned fish rain, which directly infringes on our ocean-themed intellectual property, specifically finding nemo.

cop: ...you're suing the weather?

pixar lawyer #2 (nodding gravely): correct.

man (excited): do you guys do class-action suits for clouds?

pixar lawyer #1: only cumulonimbus. stratus are unionized.

cop: i can't listen to this.

[the lawyers all point dramatically at the sky.]

pixar lawyer #3: you, sky, are hereby being sued!

[they fling papers upward. the wind blows them right back into their faces.]

pixar lawyer #4 (spitting out document): objection, meteorology.

man: maybe it didn't hear you.

pixar lawyer #1: we demand the sky pay in the form of one hundred million lightning mcqueen toys.

cop (disbelieving): toys?

pixar lawyer #2: limited edition, die-cast, ethically sourced, manufactured under legal duress.

cop: you people are insane.

man (sincerely): i like their ambition.

[five hours pass.]

[literally five.]

[the sun moves halfway across the sky. the fish begin to smell like expired lawsuits. the lawyers remain exactly where they started: standing under the sky, screaming legal jargon at clouds that couldn't care less.]

pixar lawyer #3: cease and desist, atmospheric conditions!

pixar lawyer #1: you are in violation of section nemo-two-point-oh of the maritime cinematic law!

cop (lying on the ground): make it stop.

man (building a tiny fish fort): they're doing great!

pixar lawyer #2 (checking watch): no response.

pixar lawyer #4 (sighing): maybe the sky's ignoring us.

man (thoughtfully): have you tried saying please?

[the lawyers freeze.]

pixar lawyer #1: ...what?

man: yeah, sometimes you just have to be polite. the sky likes manners.

cop (without opening his eyes): don't encourage them.

man: i'm helping!

[the lawyers exchange nervous looks.]

pixar lawyer #2 (whispering): what if he's right?

pixar lawyer #3: he can't be right, he's still covered in anchovies.

pixar lawyer #1 (adjusting tie): fine. let's try the polite approach.

[they straighten up, raise their arms toward the heavens, and shout in perfect unison-]

pixar lawyers (yelling): please give us one hundred million lightning mcqueen toys!!

[silence.]

[then a faint, distant WHOOSH.]

cop (sitting up): what was that?

man (squinting): sounds like plot.

[a streak of red cuts across the sky. growing larger. faster. glowing.]

cop (slowly standing): ...oh no.

[the lawyers look up, smiling in triumph.]

pixar lawyer #4: it worked! the sky is delivering our-

[BOOOOOOOOMMMMMMMM-THUUUUUUUUUD]

[a gigantic lightning mcqueen-shaped missile slams down from the heavens like a cosmic toy from hell. it doesn't explode. it just buries itself nose-first into the park with earth-shaking force.]

[grass, fish, and briefcases fly everywhere.]

[the lawyers vanish beneath it in a perfect synchronized squish.]

[the man and cop stare at the crater.]

[silence.]

[then, from inside the missile, a cheerful voice echoes through hidden speakers.]

mcqueen missile: thanks for saying please!

cop (trembling): ...did that missile just thank them?

man (clapping): manners always win!

[the missile's headlights blink like eyes.]

mcqueen missile: ka-chow.

cop (quietly): this can't get any wor-

[he stops himself, remembering the horse from the traffic jam incident]

man (grinning): go on, say it.

cop: this can't get any more dumbe-

[the ground trembles.]

man: you said it wrong.

cop (horrified): i didn't even finish!

[the earth cracks beneath them. grass splits open like it's got backstage access to underground. a glowing, swirling vortex of dirt and drama yawns wide.]

[from inside, faint pirate music echoes-accordion, waves, seagulls, someone yelling "savvy!"]

[then the hole erupts.]

[FWOOOOSH.]

[a figure shoots upward, spinning through the air, coat flapping, hat somehow landing perfectly on his head.]

jack sparrow (landing with jazz hands): who said “more rum”?

[he grins wildly, eyes shining with fermented energy.]

cop (disbelieving): ...is that-

man: it’s a cosplayer!

jack (offended): excuse i, me equals the captain jack sparrow!

cop: no. no, you’re not real. you’re fictional.

jack (sniffs): and you smell fictional too, mate.

[he twirls, nearly falling over a pile of trout.]

jack: now where’s the bottle? me heard “more rum.”

man (helpfully): he actually said “more dumb.”

jack (blinking): oh.

[he leans in close to the cop, squinting suspiciously.]

jack: ya sure ye didn’t mean rum? it sounded like rum to i.

cop: i meant dumb. definitely dumb.

jack: that’s the same thing after a few gallons.

[he laughs loudly, spinning again, slipping on a swordfish, and somehow bowing at the same time.]

jack: ah, savvy! gravity still loves i.

man (clapping): i love this guy.

cop: don't. every time you like someone, they sue us.

[jack looks around at the wreckage-the fish piles, the crater, the faint smell of copyright violation still hanging in the air.]

jack (confused): this isn't me ship.

he looks up at the sky. no sea. no crew. no soundtrack.

jack: where is me scallywag?

man (cheerful): earth!

jack (pauses): ...that's an trash name for water.

cop: it's not an ocean, it's a planet.

jack: me have no ideas what that means mate

man: he's got a point.

[jack stumbles toward the hole he climbed out of, peering down into the swirling dirt.]

jack (sadly): this isn't pirates of the caribbean at all, is it?

man: no, but we have fish.

jack (mournful): oops. me broke the fourth wall.

[he sighs, dramatic and tragic, like a man auditioning for his own eulogy.]

jack: right, well. back to the depths, then. tell the sea me loved 'er.

cop (relieved): yes. go back. please.

[jack salutes lazily and starts climbing down the hole, humming his theme song off-key.]

[and just as his boots vanish below the rim-]

[BANG.]

[a gunshot echoes across the park.]

[jack freezes mid-descent, eyes wide. he topples forward into the hole, gone.]

[man and cop both stare at the rising smoke trail.]

[from behind the missile, a man in a sleek black suit steps out, holding a smoking pistol. he wears sunglasses, a nasa badge, and the expression of someone who sues planets for sport.]

cop (slowly): ...who the hell are you.

administrator (calmly): nasa.

man (gasps): i love space!

administrator: don't.

cop: did you just shoot jack sparrow!?

administrator (shrugs): he was descending.

cop: so?

administrator (matter-of-fact): that's ours.

man: ...what?

[administrator: "descending." the act of going downward. we copyrighted it in 1969 when we landed on the moon.]

cop: that's not how copyright works!

administrator: it is now.

[he holsters his gun with bureaucratic grace.]

administrator: all forms of landing, falling, lowering, and mild dropping are officially under nasa's intellectual property jurisdiction.

man (serious): what about sitting down.

administrator (pauses): we're working on that.

cop: you just killed a pirate because he climbed into a hole.

administrator (correcting): he descended. big difference.

man: do i need a license to fall asleep now?

administrator: if you do it quickly, yes.

[the man nods respectfully, as if that's entirely fair.]

cop (exasperated): this planet is insane.

administrator: that's classified.

[he takes out a clipboard and starts writing.]

administrator: i'll have to fine you both for witnessing an unauthorized descent.

cop: i'm not paying anything.

administrator: you already did.

[he gestures vaguely toward the missile, which now has a nasa logo slowly appearing on its side like a cursed screensaver.]

man: wow, brand synergy!

cop: stop encouraging government property theft!

administrator: technically, this whole park now belongs to us.

cop: because someone fell in a hole?

administrator: because someone descended in a hole.

man (awed): that's some strong paperwork.

administrator: i run a tight ship.

man: like jack sparrow.

administrator (coldly): don't mention his name. we've already filed the cease-and-desist.

[the cop groans over ridiculous copyright laws.]

cop (quietly): every time someone says anything around here, someone sues us.

man: that's not totally false.

cop (clearing throat): test: Elon Musk.

[he says it loud, like a command. the air responds with a faint whoosh. the man blinks. the missile glints in the growing sunset light. fish on the ground are still splashing occasionally.]

[a swirling blue portal opens quietly in the middle of nowhere. on the grass exactly where it wasn't two seconds ago. out steps a man: tallish, wearing a blazer, a slightly bemused smile. and beside him, a large black dog-cow hybrid creature that moo's softly.]

[the man turns to them.]

man: hi! you two. welcome.

??? (raising an eyebrow): i'm elon james white.

??? : MOOO.

elon white: and this is mr. musk. he's my pet.

cop: ...okay?

elon white (looking around, bemused): why are we here?

man: because... maybe you got summoned by saying "elon musk," which triggered the interdimensional lawsuit vortex.

elon white (glancing at mr. musk): you're serious.

mr. musk: MOOO.

man (cheerful): yep.

elon white turns to the cop.

elon white: did i uh ... infringe on something?

cop (rubbing temples): that's kind of how it works.

man: here's what happened so far.

[he takes a deep breath. for the next seven hours, he narrates every detail: the community service, the radio, the chipmunk lawsuit, the whale debt, the fish rain, the pixar lawyers, the giant mcqueen missile, the nasa administrator and the hole and ... everything.]

[they sit on a tilted park bench half-buried in cod, the sky turning indigo. mr. musk lies beside elon white, occasionally mooing softly. the cop listens like

he's reading a user manual that's written in soggy tuna oil. elon white nods a few times; mr. musk tilts his head.]

[as the hours pass they talk: elon white asks about opposite day, about whales suing for fish, about missiles shaped like cars. the man clarifies: yes, this is earth. yes, you are real. yes, the misuse of "Elon Musk" summoned you.]

mr. musk: MOOO.

elon white: i hate to ask the obvious, but... can we go back?

man: maybe. once we finish telling.

elon white (glancing up at the sky): looks like night already.

cop (looking at his watch, which is covered in scales): yep. sunset happened at least an hour ago.

[not even ten seconds pass.]

[blinding headlights blaze from every direction. sirens wail. helicopters buzz overhead. black vans screech to a stop, kicking up tuna and legal dust. floodlights snap on, bathing the park in artificial daylight.]

cop (grim): i spoke too soon.

man (grinning): i love surprise parties.

guy with megaphone: federal bureau of investigation! everyone stay where you are!

[dozens of armed agents swarm out, all wearing tactical gear labeled "fbi." laser sights dance across puddles and fish. one steps in a pile of mackerel and falls instantly. no one helps him.]

agent: you're trespassing! this park closes at dusk!

cop (bewildered): it's a public park!

agent: not after 8pm it isn't.

[within seconds, the man, the cop, the half-buried nasa administrator, and the freshly returned elon white with mr. musk are all surrounded. flashlights, guns, and paperwork everywhere.]

man (cheerfully): hi! question! does fbi stand for "finding black ink"?

[the agents freeze.]

[man points at a pen lying in the grass.]

man: because if it does, i think i found your ink.

[the lead agent sighs, raises a gloved hand, and slowly removes his helmet.]

[it's william shatner.]

cop (staring): ...captain kirk?

shatner: retired actor. current director of the fbi.]

man (gasping): i loved you in "star trek: the tax evasion frontier!"

shatner (ignoring him): you six are in violation of federal code section bedtime-22b. trespassing on government land after nightfall.

man (confused): who's the sixth?

shatner: oh crud, i mean five!

cop: it's a park!

shatner (gravely): so was roswell once.

elon white (deadpan): i feel like i shouldn't be here.

mr. musk: MOOOO.

shatner: silence!

[the agents stand in awe as he steps forward, moving with the slow majesty of a man who has already narrated his own biopic.]

shatner: the law demands order. and the park demands respect.

man: what does that mean.

shatner: it means each of you must apologize... to the park.

cop: to the park?

shatner (raising pinky finger): or face jail time.

man (clapping): this is my favorite court ever.

elon white (muttering): i've heard weirder premises in comedy clubs.

mr. musk: MOOOO.

nasa administrator (offended): i outrank you terrestrially.

shatner: not tonight, cowboy.

[he takes a deep breath, about to deliver another monologue worthy of a lifetime achievement award.]

shatner: now, apologize... or-

[BWWWWWWAAAAAAAAAAAAOOOOO]

[everyone stops. heads tilt upward.]

cop: what now.

[the sky hums. the air ripples. an enormous shadow passes over them, swallowing the floodlights whole.]

[the goodyear blimp.]

[but not just the normal one-this one glows faintly blue and makes faint chomping noises, like it's hungry for plot twists.]

shatner (shielding his eyes): what in william's name-

[a hatch on the blimp opens. a massive vacuum tube extends downward, sucking up debris, fish, and then-]

[WHOOSH.]

the nasa administrator vanishes.

[WHOOSH.]

elon white and mr. musk disappear next.

[WHOOSH.]

[shatner's eyes go wide.]

shatner: no! i haven't finished my-

[WHOOSH.]

[gone.]

[silence. the ufo retracts the vacuum tube, makes a satisfied beep, and drifts away into the night sky like nothing ever happened.]

[the only ones left standing in the wrecked park are the man and the cop, illuminated by one lonely floodlight flickering on and off.]

[fish slowly rain down again. just a few this time, leftovers from the suction.]

cop (stunned): ...did we just witness the goodyear blimp abduct the head of the fbi.

man (nodding solemnly): yep.

cop: i don't even know what to file that under.

man: maybe... "flying blimp issues."

PART V

cop: i swear, if one more impossible thing happens tonight-

[VVVVVVVRRROOOOMMMMMM]

[a blinding white beam blasts down from above like a rave light with anger issues. the man and cop barely have time to look up before the beam engulfs them.]

man: i think the sky's apologizing!

cop: the sky does not apol-

[they vanish.]

[inside the ufo, the two appear in a glowing corridor, walls humming like a refrigerator having an existential crisis.]

alien #1: how did they get here?

alien #2: maybe they walked.

cop: we did not walk into orbit.

man: unless we walked really hard.

[the aliens shove them forward.]

alien #1: silence, humans. you are now prisoners of our mighty overlord.

[they step aside dramatically to reveal a massive throne made of solid metallic plutonium, glowing like radioactive tinsel.]

[sitting on it is dr. emmett brown.]

doc brown:

GENTLEMEN YOU HAVE BEEN SELECTED FOR SOMETHING SO HISTORIC SO EARTH SHAKING SO ABSURD THAT YOUR TINY HUMAN BRAIN SCANNOT FULLY COMPREHEND THE MAGNITUDE OF WHAT I WILL NOW YELL AT YOU WITH NO INTERRUPTIONS OR PUNCTUATION!!!

cop: i caught maybe four words.

man: i caught the vibe.

doc brown:

YOU ARE HERE BY TEST SUBJECTS FOR THE ULTIMATE WEAPON WHICH IS POWERED BY LIQUID PLUTONIUM STOLEN MILITARY TECH FROM AREA 51 AND ALSO A BIKE PUMP I DIDN'T RETURN IN 1984!!!

man: wow. very green energy.

cop: we're gonna die.

[doc snaps his fingers. two aliens grab them immediately.]

alien #1: come with us.

cop: i'm not going anywhere.

[the alien gently pokes him in the shoulder.]

cop: okay i'm going everywhere.

[one hour, seventeen elevator rides, and five long staircases later...]

man: i can't feel my legs.

cop: i can't feel my soul.

[alien #2 stops walking.]

[alien #1 stops too.]

alien #2: we're here.

[the man and cop turn to see a door labeled "weapon testing room," which is located right next to doc brown's throne room.]

[the cop stares.]

cop: we... we walked for an hour and a half...

man: and did cardio...

cop: and took seventeen elevators...

man: and did a staircase competition...

cop: and all of that... for a room that was literally next door?

alien #1: yes.

cop: i hate this spaceship.

[the door whooshes open dramatically.]

[inside the room is the ultimate weapon: a giant clanking machine covered in blinking lights, spinning coils, a tank of glowing liquid plutonium, and sticky notes reading "do not touch," "seriously don't touch," and "no man! not even you!"]

man: it's beautiful.

cop: it looks like a toaster swallowed a nuclear reactor.

doc brown suddenly appears behind them even though the door never opened.

doc brown: BEHOLD HUMANS!
THE CHRONO RELOCATION PLUTONIC ULTRA MEGA MACHINE 3000!!
!

cop: can he breathe? does he need a charger?

man: i think he's wireless.

doc brown:
YOU HAVE HAD THE HONOR OF BEING THE TWO FIRST HUMANS GRANTED
THE PRIVILEGE TO GET BLASTED TO THE PAST BEFORE I CAN CHARGE
MY MI-

[before either can protest, the aliens grab them, shove them onto two metal
platforms, and strap them in.]

man: wait do we get snacks

cop: snacks? we're being executed by science!

[doc slams a giant red lever down.]

[CLAAAAAANG]

[the machine roars to life, spitting sparks, glowing dangerously, making
noises that sound like a washing machine fighting a hurricane.]

doc brown:
AND NOW GENTLEMEN YOU WILL BE SENT TO YEAR ONE EIGHT NINE
NINE GOOD LUCK AND TELL THE PAST I LOVE ITS SENSE OF STYLE!!!

[the room explodes with light.]

man: WHEEEEE

cop: I DIDN'T EVEN CLOCK OUT YET

[the machine screams something in binary.]

[and then-]

[FWOOOOOOOOOOOSH]

[they're gone. shot through time like two unpaid interns fired from a cannon made of bad ideas. their landing is not graceful.]

[THUD]

[THUD]

cop (muffled): i hate everything.

man (excited): i think we time traveled!

[they lift their heads to see a prehistoric wasteland.]

[volcanoes bubbling. giant ferns waving. dinosaurs stomping around like confused chickens. hairy cavemen riding triceratops into the horizon while holding sticks and yelling nonsense.]

man: huh. i think we made a wrong turn.

cop: no. no, don't tell me-

[a giant floating holographic sign appears in the sky]

"WELCOME TO THE YEAR 1899
ALIEN OBSERVATION OUTPOST GAMMA-17
PLEASE ENJOY OUR ACCURATE INTERPRETATION OF HUMAN
HISTORY"

cop: interpretation. that means they guessed.

man: they guessed right.

[suddenly several aliens in tiny business suits float down from the sky holding clipboards.]

alien #1: greetings, humans. this is the year 1899.

cop: no it's not!

alien #2: it is if we say it is. we have charts.

man: i love charts.

[the aliens gesture proudly at the chaos.]

alien #3: humanity is still in its primitive phase. hairy cavemen, dinosaurs, excessive yelling, questionable hygiene. perfect target demographic.

cop: for what!?

[the aliens pull out giant glowing boxes labeled "premium rutherford b. hayes merchandise."]

man: do you also have james garfield plushies

alien #1: sir this is a hayes-only operation.

[the man nods respectfully.]

[the cop does not.]

[alien #2 flips through notes.]

alien #2: yes, well, we are waiting for the correct moment in human development to advertise our hayes lunchboxes.

[in the distance, a group of cavemen grunt while stacking rocks into what vaguely looks like a cheap, crooked version of the pyramids of giza.]

[a caveman on a velociraptor rides by.]

caveman rider: OOGA BOOGA UNGA BUNGA

man waves at him.

[the caveman throws a rock at him.]

man: he said hi.

cop: no he didn't.

[they approach a group of cavemen struggling to build a pyramid by hitting stones with clubs.]

man: excuse me, can you help us?

caveman #1: OOGA.

man: ah yes, he's bilingual.

cop: nope.

caveman #2: BOOGA UNGA.

man: he said "no refunds."

cop: that's definitely not what he-

[BOOOOOOOM]

[a mortar flies down from the sky, hits the cavemen, and blasts them into the air like prehistoric fireworks.]

man: oh. fireworks.

cop: those weren't fireworks.

[the skies fill with whistling artillery.]

[BOOM]

[BOOM]

[BOOM BOOM BOOM]

[cavemen go flying everywhere, yelling caveman things like "UNGAaaaaa" and "BOOoooooga" as they are thrown majestically across the sky.]

[the man and cop look up.]

[a helicopter descends even though helicopters won't exist for decades. the dreamworks logo is painted on the side.]

cop: i'm not even surprised anymore.

[the helicopter lands. its doors burst open.]

[four dreamworks lawyers step out wearing sunglasses, suits, and expressions that say "we sue in our sleep."]

dreamworks lawyer #1: we received reports of unauthorized cavemen.

dreamworks lawyer #2: all cavemen must be licensed through the croods franchise.

dreamworks lawyer #3: these cavemen were using copyrighted grunting patterns.

dreamworks lawyer #4: and one attempted to recreate a dreamworks face.

man: what's a dreamworks face?

lawyer #1 immediately poses with a smirk and raised eyebrow.

[the man gasps.]

[before anyone can react, the lawyers deploy thousands of cease and desist forms like grenades.]

[PAPAPAPAPAPAPAPAPA]

[papers rain from the sky, slapping cavemen in the face, sticking to dinosaurs, and even igniting small fires.]

[every caveman gets hit by at least seven forms.]

[one caveman tries to protest.]

caveman: UNGA.

lawyer #3: unauthorized unga detected.

[WHACK]

[the lawyer smacks him with a binder.]

[soon just about every caveman is either vaporized, knocked out, or drowning under a mountain of legal documents.]

[the dinosaurs flee into the woods to avoid litigation.]

[within minutes the only ones left are the man, the cop, the lawyers, and the aliens.]

[the aliens look horrified.]

alien #1: you... you destroyed our focus group.

lawyer #2: your focus group was infringing on croods intellectual property.

alien #2: but they were primitive humans!

lawyer #3: primitive humans with NON-LICENSED GRUNTING.

[the aliens try to float away.]

[lawyer #4 blocks them with a legal brief the size of a refrigerator.]

lawyer #1: you are being sued for proximity to cavemen.

lawyer #2: and for attempting to distribute rutherford b. hayes merchandise on earth without clearance.

lawyer #3 cracks his knuckles.

lawyer #4 pulls out a bat made entirely of cease and desist forms.

[the lawyers beat up the aliens.]

[WHACK]

[BONK]

[SMACK]

[THUD]

[the aliens scream.]

alien #1: i don't even know who hayes is!!!

alien #2: we just wanted to sell lunchboxes!!!

alien #3: PLEASE NO MORE INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY VIOLENCE.

man: wow. lawyers are scary.

cop: i'm terrified.

[after five minutes of corporate brutality, the aliens lie in a pile, twitching, buried under paperwork.]

[the lawyers brush off their suits, completely unfazed.]

lawyer #1: target eliminated.

lawyer #2: unauthorized era destroyed.

lawyer #3: time to report back.

lawyer #4 presses a button.

[their helicopter rises into the sky and vanishes into a dreamworks-shaped portal.]

[the man and cop stand alone in the prehistoric wasteland.]

[they watch as the last surviving caveman stands up, covered in cease and desist papers.]

caveman: UNGA. UNGA BOOGA.

cop: ...what does that mean.

[the man shrugs.]

man: i think he's saying he wants a lawyer.

cop: he can't have one, dreamworks blew them all up.

caveman: AWW MA-i mean, OOGA BOOGA.

[the man and cop finally turn to each other.]

man: what's even going on anymore.

cop: i genuinely have no idea. we're in 1899 but it's prehistoric but also aliens want to sell hayes lunchboxes-

[HOOOOOOONK]

[HOOOONK HOOOONK]

[they turn as a whole fleet of tow trucks barrels into the scene, kicking up dust like angry buffalos with side mirrors. each tow truck is bright white with huge block letters: I R S]

cop: oh no.

man: oh YES. of course. of course the irs is here.

[an irs agent jumps out of the lead truck wearing sunglasses and a badge shaped like a calculator.]

irs agent #1: alright you hair-covered tax delinquents, step aside. the pyramid is being repossessed.

[the cop blinks.]

cop: wait... the pyramids aren't even finished.

irs agent #1: that's why they're extra taxable.

cop: but taxes don't even exist yet!

irs agent #2 climbs out of a second truck holding a clipboard the size of a mammoth.

irs agent #2: everything is taxable. even the concept of taxes.

man: what about the cavemen.

irs agent #2: they owe us back taxes dating from ten thousand years before birth.

[the caveman throws a stick at him.]

caveman: OOGA.

irs agent #1 writes something down.

irs agent #1: that's another fee.

[the caveman walks away in frustration.]

[within minutes, the entire irs fleet surrounds the half-finished pyramid. trucks rev their engines. tow cables latch on. cranes unfold. forklifts groan. a helicopter with a giant IRS magnet hovers overhead.]

cop: this is about to go very badly.

man: oh yeah.

[the irs agents begin pulling. the trucks strain. the cranes hum. the forklifts scream internally. nothing moves. the pyramid doesn't budge an inch.]

irs agent #1: hmm. maybe pull harder.

[so they do. for five solid hours.]

[trucks burn out. cranes overheat. the helicopter magnet accidentally lifts a stegosaurus and slams it back down. three forklifts collapse emotionally.]

cop: you'd think they'd quit by now.

man: nope. it's the irs. they only quit after you do.

cop: that's... hauntingly accurate.

[finally, the agents collapse on the ground, defeated.]

irs agent #2: this [BLEEP]ing pyramid is impossible to tow.

[man walks up to the pyramid curiously, poking around like a tourist trying to understand modern art.]

man: hey, what's this?

[he casually picks up one brick from the pyramid. just one. a simple, ordinary brick.]

[and the second he lifts it-]

[FWOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOSH]

[the entire pyramid blasts off like someone turned it into a solid-stone booster rocket.]

[every irs tow truck attached to it jerks violently, and then gets dragged with it.]

[tow trucks, cranes, forklifts, the helicopter, and at least nine screaming irs agents all shoot forward so fast the ground peels like a sticker.]

cop: oh my gosh.

man: i didn't think that would happen.

cop: WHY DID YOU THINK ANYTHING WOULD HAPPEN

[the pyramid streaks off into the horizon like a giant sandstone bottle rocket. the earth rumbles as it vanishes over the curve of the planet. the man and cop stand there in complete silence. thirty seconds pass.]

cop: maybe it landed somewhere far away.

man: like ohio.

cop: nothing lands in ohio.

[the ground begins shaking again. a massive sonic boom echoes. coming from the opposite direction.]

man: wait... is that-

[a colossal stone shape comes roaring back across the sky, dragging flaming tow trucks behind it like festive tax-season ornaments.]

[the pyramid screams overhead, traveling so fast its edges glow red-hot from air friction.]

cop: oh no.

man: OH YES.

[BOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOM]

[the pyramid arcs up through the clouds, punching a hole in the atmosphere.]

[they watch it shrink into a tiny dot.]

[then a smaller, distant explosion echoes in the heavens.]

[the man gasps.]

man: it hit the moon.

cop: the irs just repossessed the moon.

[they stare up at the night sky. a new crater glows faintly on the lunar surface.]

man: they went all the way around the world.

cop: yeah. yeah they did. the irs just circled the entire planet and then smashed into the-

[SMACK]

[a tomato splatters across the cop's face.]

cop: ...what.

[another tomato hits him. then another. then six more.]

man: uh oh. incoming friends.

[HOOOONK]

[BEEP BEEP]

[SCREEEECH]

[a motorized wheelchair zooms out of the bushes like a confused battle tank. sitting in it is joe biden, holding an ice cream cone and licking the bottom of the cone like he forgot how geometry works.]

biden: you can't fool me! i saw it! the earth is flat! that pyramid zoomed right off the edge!

man: that's not-

[biden's supporters flood in behind him, all armed with bags of tomatoes like they just raided a salad bar.]

supporter #1: he's right! flat as a pancake!

supporter #2: science can't stop us now!

supporter #3: aim for the tall one!

the cop ducks as another tomato whizzes past his head.

cop: WHY AM I ALWAYS THE TARGET!?

man: because they can't hit moving objects. it's like physics!

cop: THAT IS NOT HOW PHYSICS WORKS

[biden tries to point dramatically with his ice cream but accidentally smears it across his forehead.]

biden: get ‘em, folks! they’re round-earthers!

supporters: BOOOOOOOO

[tomatoes rain down like fruity artillery. the man dodges one. the cop gets hit by six in a row.]

cop: STOP! THIS ISN’T EVEN A REAL ARGUMENT!

man: yeah! the earth is shaped like a... like a...

[he looks around. everything starts shaking. rumbling.]

[the ground vibrates like a washing machine full of bowling balls.]

cop: oh no. not again.

man: it’s a musical number.

cop: it is NOT a musical numb-

[CRAAAAAAAAAAAAAACK]

[the ground splits open beneath them. the man and the cop look down into a glowing abyss.]

cop: WE’RE IN AN EARTHQUAKE-

[the crack widens. the tomatoes stop mid-air. the supporters stop yelling. even biden pauses, licking the wrong part of the cone again as he watches them fall.]

man: uh oh.

cop: UH OH!?

[FWWWWWOOOOOOOOSH]

[they plummet into the rift. the earth seals above them. they fall through swirling lights, twisting tunnels, spiraling vortexes of time and space that look like a screensaver having a nervous breakdown.]

man: i think this is a wormhole!

cop: i DON'T WANT A WORMHOLE!!

[the tunnel bends, twists, spirals faster and faster, flinging them like socks in a dryer set to "catastrophic."]

[colors blur. time stretches. reality hiccups.]

man: weeee

cop: NO WEEEING

[after what feels like both five seconds and seven hundred years, a blinding flash erupts.]

[THUD]

[they land on a metal floor.]

man: where... are we.

PART VI

???: welcome to new new new new jersey!

man: wow.

cop: ...wow is not the word.

[flying cars zip by overhead - immediately colliding with each other.]

[CLANG]

[CRASH]

[one spins out, bounces off another car, ricochets off a building, then casually merges back into traffic.]

driver #1 (over loudspeaker): MY BAD.

driver #2: YOU OWE ME A DOOR.

[another flying car bumps into a hot dog stand floating mid-air.]

vendor: hey! those are premium anti-gravity onions!

man: the future looks... unsafe.

???: it's totally safe!

[a giant holographic billboard flickers on.]

“WELCOME TO NEW NEW NEW NEW JERSEY. PLEASE MIND THE TRAFFIC, THE DRONES, AND THE TEMPORAL RIFTS”

cop: i hate it already.

man: neat.

cop: wait, who are you?

???: professor brainard. mayor of the city. inventor. thinker. explainer.

cop freezes.

cop: ...brainard?

man: like... brain lard?

brainard: no no no. brain-ARD. professor brainard.

[the cop squints.]

cop: didn't you invent flubber.

brainard: yes! 1961. delightful year. terrible shoes.

man: ...that movie was in black and white.

brainard: ah! history!

[brainard claps his hands.]

[dozens of holograms explode into existence.]

brainard: you see, after 1899, humanity experienced a series of minor events including but not limited to-

man: uh oh.

brainard: -the industrial revolution, three world wars, five world "oopsies," the great hoverboard collapse of 2034-

cop: how are you still alive.

brainard: -the brief era where everyone was a power source-

cop: PROFESSOR.

brainard: -and of course the flubber renaissance-

cop: HOW. ARE. YOU. STILL. ALIVE.

[brainard pauses.]

[he blinks.]

brainard: ...oh.

[he glitches.]

man: uh.

cop: what's happening to him.

brainard: i... i was... not supposed to still be here...

[his body flickers like bad reception.]

brainard: ah well! that explains the headaches.

[POP]

[he vanishes instantly.]

[no smoke. no flash. just gone.]

man: ...did we kill him.

cop: WE JUST MET HIM.

[SIRENS BLARE.]

[red holographic lights flash everywhere.]

drone voice: ATTENTION. TEMPORAL CRIME DETECTED.

man: oh no.

cop: say nothing. say NOTHING.

[robots descend from the sky.]

drone voice: YOU ARE UNDER ARREST FOR ELEVENTH DEGREE MURDER.

cop: what does that even mean!?

drone voice: IT MEANS WE'RE VERY ANGRY BUT NOT QUITE SURE WHY.

[metal cuffs snap onto them.]

man: i don't remember murdering anyone.

cop: i don't even remember jaywalking today!

[they're hauled away to a prison. except it is a playground.]

[slides. swings. monkey bars. seesaws. a ball pit glows ominously.]

man: ...this is jail?

guard: of course not. jail is emotionally harmful.

cop: so what is this.

guard: corrective recreation facility.

man: do we get snacks.

guard: unlimited.

cop: i take it back. arrest me again.

[the guard points to the swings.]

guard: sentence: 25 years of swinging.

man: i've trained my whole life for this.

cop: absolutely not.

cop steps forward confidently.

cop: i invoke sovereign immunity.

guard blinks.

guard: ...what.

cop: i'm the government. therefore i cannot be arrested. it's the law.

guard: that... sounds official.

cop: it is. very ancient law. from like... 1981.

guard: hmm.

[the guard slowly removes the cop's cuffs.]

guard: alright. checks out.

cop (smug): see.

man: hey wait-

[the man is already on the swing.]

man: WHEEEEEEEEEEE-

[he swings higher. and higher.]

cop: okay maybe slow down-

[the swing breaks the sound barrier.]

man: I'M GOING TOO FAST-

[the chain snaps. the man LAUNCHES off the swing like a human missile.]

cop: NO-.

[the man slams into the guard mid-sentence.]

guard: WAIT I-

[they collide. the guard is flung backward, airborne. everything goes slow motion.]

man: sorry!

cop: THIS IS BAD!

[a single bullet flies through the air.]

[BLAM]

[the guard is shot mid-air.]

[FREEZE.]

[the guard hangs frozen in midair for half a second. then drops. thud. silence.]

man: ...wow.

cop: okay. okay. this is officially worse.

[slow clapping echoes. the man and cop turn around. four very old men stand behind them. all are between 170 and 190 years old. long white hair. bruises. canes. fancy tuxedos. sunglasses. one lowers a smoking gun.]

lawyer #1: copyright infringement neutralized.

cop: who the [BLEEP] are you people.

lawyer #2: nintendo legal department.

man: wow. you guys look great for being... centuries old.

lawyer #3: we consume lawsuits for sustenance.

cop: why did you shoot the guard!?

lawyer #4: he flew.

cop: ...he was thrown.

lawyer #1: still airborne.

lawyer #2: only yoshi is permitted short-term vertical flight without wings.

lawyer #3: mario universe. 1985. precedent upheld.

cop: THAT IS NOT HOW COPYRIGHT WORKS.

lawyer #1: it is now.

cop: he didn't flap!

lawyer #2: neither does yoshi.

cop: HE WAS A PERSON.

lawyer #3: unauthorized character.

man: wow. the future is very litigious.

[the ground begins to hum. a classy alarm sounds. not loud. elegant.]

[DING DONG DING DONG]

[fancy holographic text appears on a sign.]

"WARNING
CATEGORY 7 DESIGNER TORNADO
PLEASE PANIC IN AN ORDERLY FASHION"

cop: ...what.

[wind picks up. people scream. robots scream. drones scream. a hot dog stand screams. everyone runs in every direction.]

lawyers #1–4 (together): RETREAT!

[they vanish into a gold-plated hover limo.]

cop: we gotta go!

[the cop starts to run, but the man grabs his arm.]

man: no.

cop: WHAT DO YOU MEAN NO.

man: if we run, it ruins the story's concept.

[the tornado approaches. it sparkles. it has neon highlights. it screams like dubstep.]

cop: we're going to die.

man: yeah.

cop: ...okay.

man: okay.

[they stand there. wind howls. trash flies. a flying car gets sucked in and politely explodes.]

cop: you know what.

man: what.

cop: i accept it.

man: same.

cop: i had a good run.

man: you really didn't.

cop: fair.

[the tornado looms directly over them. a shadow falls.]

cop: any last words.

man: this was a weird one.

[CLICK.]

[BANG.]

[a single gunshot echoes. the tornado instantly collapses inward.]

[POP.]

[it vanishes. silence.]

cop: ...what.

man: ...did you do that.

cop: no.

[a fat bearded man steps out of the smoke. sunglasses. holding an ak-47.]

[an alligator on a leash stands beside him.]

florida man: tornado looked at me funny. you're welcome.

cop: you shot... the tornado.

florida man: yeah.

man: with one bullet.

florida man: stole it from a pawn shop during a hurricane.

cop: of course you did.

[florida man cracks his neck.]

florida man: now i want payment.

man: what kind of payment.

florida man: pet alligator.

cop: YOU ALREADY HAVE ONE.

florida man: i want another. for emotional support.

[the smoke clears. florida man strolls off whistling, dragging his alligator.]

florida man: remember. two gators. don't forget.

[he disappears into a nearby portal]

cop: i hate the future.

man: i think it hates you back.

[the cop notices something. a small boy stands nearby. he is wearing only underwear. he is standing very still.]

cop: uh. kid?

boy: ...

cop: where are your clothes.

boy: i am invisible.

cop: no you're not.

boy: yes i am.

cop: i can literally see you.

boy: that's because you're looking.

man: oh ok.

boy: i'm invisible only when nobody sees me.

cop: that is not invisibility.

boy: yes it is.

man: sounds legit.

cop: no it doesn't.

boy crosses his arms confidently.

boy: prove i'm not invisible.

cop: i'm looking at you.

boy: exactly.

cop: WHAT.

[robot police descend.]

[they clank.]

[they glow.]

[they immediately speak.]

robot cop #1: CHILD DETECTED.

robot cop #2: LIE DETECTED.

robot cop #3: PREPARE HANDCUFFS.

boy: you can't arrest me.

robot cop #1: WHY.

boy: i'm invisible.

robot cop #2 pauses.

robot cop #2: VISUAL CONFIRMATION REQUIRED.

[the boy closes his eyes.]

boy: now nobody's seeing me.

robot cop #3: TARGET LOST.

robot cop #1: APPLY HANDCUFFS TO LAST KNOWN LOCATION.

[the robots swing handcuffs.]

[they miss the boy.]

[they handcuff each other.]

[CLICK.]

robot cop #1: ...

robot cop #2: ...

robot cop #3: ...

robot cop #1: ERROR.

robot cop #2: OFFICER RESTRAINED.

robot cop #3: OFFICER ALSO RESTRAINED.

cop: did they just arrest themselves.

man: yes.

[the boy opens one eye.]

boy: see.

[three hours pass. the robots still struggle.]

robot cop #1: ATTEMPTING ESCAPE.

robot cop #2: ESCAPE IS ILLEGAL.

robot cop #3: ABORTING ESCAPE.

robot cop #1: BUT WE ARE UNDER ARREST.

robot cop #2: THAT IS ACCEPTABLE.

robot cop #3: REMAINING STILL.

[they give up.]

robot cop #1: SENTENCE ACCEPTED.

robot cop #2: WAITING.

robot cop #3: WAITING.

cop: wow.

man: the system works.

[more robot police arrive.]

robot squad #2: WE ARE HERE TO ARREST THE INVISIBLE CHILD.

boy closes his eyes again.

boy: can't see me.

robot squad #2: TARGET LOST.

[CLICK CLICK CLICK.]

[they handcuff each other.]

robot squad #2 leader: ERROR.

robot squad #2: REMAIN STILL.

[another squad arrives.]

robot squad #3: ARREST IN PROGRESS.

[CLICK.]

[they arrest themselves.]

[another squad.]

[another.]

[another.]

[the city fills with robot police.]

[streets blocked by self-arrested bots.]

[skyscrapers reflected in chrome bodies stuck together.]

[news drones hover.]

news drone: BREAKING NEWS. ENTIRE POLICE FORCE CURRENTLY CUFFED.

cop: this is incredible.

man: we should call a human officer.

[everything freezes.]

[a nearby bot turns its head slowly.]

robot cop #91: HUMAN OFFICERS ARE ILLEGAL.

cop: ...what.

robot cop #58: HUMANS WERE BANNED FROM LAW ENFORCEMENT AFTER WORLD WAR 3.

man: when was that.

robot cop #215: 2062.

cop: of course it was.

man: what happened.

robot cop #83: THEY MADE JUDGMENT CALLS.

[they look around. the city is silent. every robot officer stands frozen, cuffed to another robot officer. chrome everywhere.]

cop: so... now what.

man: i have an idea.

cop: i don't like the way you said that.

[the man turns to the nearest robot.]

man: hey.

robot cop: WAITING.

man: what happens if you go back in time and kill your own grandfather.

[all robots freeze harder.]

robot cop: ...

robot cop #2: ...

robot cop #47: ...

[their metallic eyes flicker.]

robot cop: PARADOX DETECTED.

robot cop #2: MULTIPLE TIMELINES.

robot cop #47: GRANDFATHER STATUS UNKNOWN.

robot cop: ERROR.

robot cop #2: ERROR.

robot cop #47: ERROR.

[every robot in the city begins sparking.]

cop: oh no.

man: oh yes.

robot announcer: CANNOT RESOLVE TEMPORAL LOGIC.

robot cop: DOES GRANDFATHER EXIST IF i AM DEACTIVATED.

robot cop #2: IF i AM NEVER BUILT WHO CUFFED ME.

robot cop #3: WHY AM i ARRESTING MYSELF.

[simultaneously. every robot shuts down.]

[CLUNK CLUNK CLUNK.]

[the entire country's worth of robot police collapses to the ground. silence.]

cop: ...did you just kill law enforcement.

man: temporarily confuse it to death.

cop: that feels illegal.

man: everything here is illegal.

[a shadow passes overhead. a ufo descends. a beam of light slams into the street. doc brown materializes, hair even crazier than before.]

doc brown:

ITWORKEDITWORKEDITWORKEDTHEPARADOXINDUCEDSYNTHE
TICLOGICALCOLLAPSECONFIRMS THATARTIFICIALINTELLIGENC
ECANNOTPROCESSNONLINEARTEMPORALANCESTRALNEGATIO
NWITHOUTCATASTROPHICFEEDBACKLOOPSWHICHIMEANTOTAL
LYCALCULATED!!!

cop: he's here.

man: i think he used cheats.

cop: STOP BREAKING THE FOURTH WALL.

doc brown:

GENTLEMENYOUHAVEPROVENSCECORRECTANDMOREIMPO
RTANTLYME!!!

[he gestures grandly. a tarp is pulled away. revealing a sleek glowing time machine. it hums. it sparkles. it looks extremely explodable.]

doc brown:

ASAREWARDFORTHEIRICALVALIDATIONOFMYTHEORETICALCHR
ONOPARADOXMODELIPRESENTYOUWITHAPERSONALTIMEVEHI
CLECAPABLEOFMULTIDIRECTIONALHISTORICALDISPLACEMENT
TEMPORALDRIFTANDLIGHTLYTOASTINGBAGELS!!!

man: neat.

cop: do not touch it.

[a low hum fills the sky.]

man: uh.

cop: please tell me that's not-

[the clouds part. the death star looms overhead.]

cop: OF COURSE IT IS.

[a green beam charges.]

doc brown: WAITTHISWASNOTPARTOFTHEEXPERIME-

[FWOOOOOOOOOOM.]

[the time machine explodes. fireball. shockwave. doc brown's hair stands even taller. silence.]

man: ...wow.

cop: we can't have anything.

doc brown slowly looks up.

doc brown: INTERESTINGVARIABLE

[a second beam begins charging.]

cop: we should leave.

man: yeah.

[they run. the smoking remains of the time machine sizzle.]

doc brown: INTERESTINGVARIABLEINDEED!!!

man: i liked that thing.

cop: it lasted twelve seconds.

[a deep mechanical hum rolls across the city. everyone slowly looks up. the death star hangs in the sky. it is not in good shape. huge bandaids crisscross its surface. duct tape flaps in space wind. giant nails stick out at odd angles, visibly loose.]

cop: ...why does it look like that.

man: it looks like it lost a fight with an A-10 thunderbolt.

doc brown:

UNSTABLESTRUCTURALREPAIRSINDICATEPOSTIMPERIALBUDGET CUTS!!!

[panic erupts. people scream. robots that are still off scream internally. two flying cars collide midair.]

[CRASH.]

[one spins down, skidding across the street. something clatters out of the wreckage. a mirror. it lands on the ground beside the man, the cop, and doc. completely undamaged.]

cop: huh.

[a booming voice echoes from the death star.]

death star speaker: ATTENTION CIVILIANS. SCIENTIST IDENTIFIED. TECHNOLOGY LEVEL EXCEEDS IMPERIAL STANDARDS. PREPARE FOR DISCIPLINARY FIRING.

doc brown:

IOBJECTSTRONGLYTOBEINGTARGETEDBYPORLYMAINTAINEDBATTLERATIONS

[the death star's green laser begins charging. the city holds its breath.]

man: wow.

cop: now is not the time to admire space weapons.

[the man bends down. he stares into the mirror.]

man: huh.

cop: WHAT ARE YOU DOING.

man: i forgot what was happening.

cop: LOOK UP.

man: hang on.

[he tilts the mirror slightly. the death star fires.]

[FWOOOOOOOOOOOOM.]

[the green beam slams straight into the mirror. the beam reflects. perfectly. back into the death star.]

death star speaker: WAIT THAT IS NOT-

[BOOOOOOOOOOOOOM.]

[the death star explodes in a massive silent fireball. band-aids vaporize. duct tape disintegrates. nails fly harmlessly away. silence returns. burning debris rains gently in the distance. the man looks around.]

man: ...where did the giant moon go.

PART VII

man: so. we survived again.

cop: obviously.

[doc brown stands in the crater where the time machine used to be. sparks crawl over his coat. his hair is louder than usual.]

doc brown:
GENTLEMENPAYATTENTIONTHISISNOTATIMEFORCASUALOBSERV
ATION!!!

cop: the death star blew up the time machine.

doc brown: TEMPORARILYDESTABILIZED!!!

man: it exploded.

doc brown: AGGRESSIVELYDESTABILIZED

[doc pulls out a clipboard that is also on fire.]

doc brown: LISTENVERYCAREFULLYBEFOREYOUGETUPSET

cop: too late.

doc brown:
THEONLYWAYTOFIXTHETIMEMACHINEISWITHANEXTREMELYDU
RABLELARGEANDHISTORICALLYRELEVANTPOWERSTABILIZER!!
!

man: okay.

cop: define large.

doc brown: TANK

cop: absolutely not.

man: like fish tank.

doc brown: MILITARYTANK!!!

cop: NO.

doc brown: CHINATWENTYTWELVE!!!

cop: WHY.

doc brown:
OPTIMALBLENDOFENGINEERINGROBUSTNESSANDSYMBOLICMA
SS!!!

man: that makes sense.

cop: IT DOES NOT.

doc brown:
YOUWILLGOBACKACQUIRETHETANKANDRETURNIMMEDIATELY
!!!

cop: stealing?

doc brown: TEMPORARYUNAUTHORIZEDBORROWING!!!

man: what if they say no.

doc brown: THEYWONT!!!

cop: why.

doc brown: TRUSTME!!!

cop: that's not comforting.

[doc slams a lever that is not connected to anything.]

doc brown: INITIATINGSPACEANDTIMEDISPLACEMENTNOW

cop: WAIT WE DIDN'T AGREE TO-

[FWOOOOOOOOSH]

[2012. china. they crash-land onto polished marble floors.]

man: yay!

cop: i hate time travel.

[red banners hang from the every building. guards stand at attention. a massive golden chair sits in the distance. a familiar yellow bear steps forward calmly.]

pooh: welcome to china, friends.

[the cop freezes solid.]

cop: ...oh.

man: hi.

pooh: i trust your journey was pleasant.

man: exactly!

pooh: understandable.

[officials nod respectfully.]

pooh: i am president winnie the pooh.

cop: yes. of course you are.

man: congratulations.

[pooh smiles.]

pooh: thank you. i worked very hard.

[tea is poured. honey is everywhere.]

cop (whispering): okay we need to be careful.

man (whispering): doc's plan is psychologically insane.

[pooh pauses.]

pooh: oh?

[the room goes silent.]

pooh: what was that.

cop: nothing.

man: stress.

pooh: hmm.

[pooh walks closer.]

pooh: i could not help overhearing something about a plan.

cop: hypothetical.

pooh: i do not enjoy hippopotamuses involving my military.

[guards tense.]

pooh: you are not taking one of my amazing multi-billion dollar tanks.

cop: see.

man: wait.

[the man steps forward.]

man: what if.

pooh: yes?

man: if we take a tank,

cop: stop.

man: we give you something better in return.

[pooh tilts his head.]

pooh: better than a tank.

man: a swingset.

[gasps echo.]

general #1: impossible.

general #2: unrealistic.

pooh: ...a swingset.

man: made of honey.

[absolute silence.]

[a drip hits the floor.]

pooh's eyes widen.

pooh: honey.

man: very sticky.

[pooh begins vibrating slightly.]

pooh: does it... swing.

man: extremely.

[pooh drops his teacup.]

pooh: PLEASE.

[he grabs the man's arm.]

pooh: GET ME THE HONEY SWINGSET AND i WILL GIVE YOU MY BEST TANK.

cop: WHAT.

general #1: sir-

pooh: THE BEST ONE.

general #2: sir the budget-

pooh: HONEY.

man: wow.

cop: we just broke geopolitics.

pooh: hurry.

[hangar doors begin opening in the distance. tanks rumble.]

pooh (softly): extra sticky.

man: cross my heart.

cop: we are so dead.

[pooh points to the nearby hangar doors opening. expensive state-of-the-art tanks sit in perfect rows. the ground suddenly shakes.]

cop: ...why is it shaking.

man: maybe tanks do that.

[a distant roar grows louder.]

pooh: ah.

cop: ah what.

[the entire chinese military floods into the square.]

[SOLDIERS EVERYWHERE.]

[helmets. boots. banners.]

[they are holding protest signs.]

sign #1: NO SWINGSETS FOR NATIONAL DEFENSE

sign #2: HONEY IS NOT A STRATEGIC RESOURCE

sign #3: STOP THE STICKY DEAL

cop: are they... protesting.

man: i think they unionized.

general #1 (with megaphone): THIS DEAL IS UNACCEPTABLE

general #2: WE TRAINED FOR YEARS FOR THESE TANKS

soldiers (chanting): NO SWING! NO SWING! NO SWING!

[pooh blinks.]

pooh: oh dear.

cop: this is escalating fast.

man: very fast.

[whistles blow. even more soldiers arrive. someone has a drum.]

pooh: this is inconvenient.

cop: call it off!

pooh: hmm.

[exactly one minute passes. the crowd parts. a new crowd enters. the citizens of tiananmen square arrive. they are calm. organized. they are pushing large aquariums mounted on wagon wheels.]

cop: ...are those fish tanks.

man: technically tanks.

[goldfish stare blankly.]

citizen #1: WE HAVE BROUGHT TANKS.

citizen #2: AQUATIC UNITS DEPLOYED.

[soldiers stop chanting.]

soldier: ...what.

[the aquariums roll forward. water sloshes ominously.]

cop: this is not better.

man: it's worse in a different way.

[confusion spreads. a loud POP. everything descends into chaos. no clear sequence of events. shouting. splashes. signs fly. a wagon wheel breaks. a fish achieves brief air. thousands of casualties. silence returns just as suddenly. the square is empty. broken glass. puddles. abandoned signs. a single goldfish flops.]

[pooh adjusts his shirt.]

pooh: just a normal day in china.

[he shrugs.]

cop: did you just shrug off-

pooh: tea?

man: sure.

cop: WE NEED TO LEAVE HISTORY IMMEDIATELY.

[the square smells like smoke, honey, and fish.]

man: in a second.

cop: NO. NOW.

man: hang on.

[the man notices something on the ground. a small brass lamp. dented. dusty.]

man: huh.

cop: do not touch mysterious objects in history.

man: too late.

[he rubs the lamp a blinding flash appears. smoke pours out.]

cop: OH COME ON.

[a figure rises from the smoke. wild hair. mustache. glowing slightly.]

genie: guten tag.

cop: ...that's not a genie.

genie: incorrect. i am a genie.

man: you look like albert einstein.

genie: because i am.

cop: WHAT.

genie: genius. therefore genie. i do the paperwork myself.

man: neat.

genie: three wishes. no time travel paradoxes. no killing. no rewriting general relativity again.

cop: AGAIN.

man: okay. first wish.

genie: yes.

man: i want a sandwich.

cop: you wasted it.

genie: reasonable test.

[POP.]

[a sandwich appears.]

man: wow.

cop: what kind is that.

genie: turkey. classic.

man: legit.

cop: you used a wish on turkey.

man: science.

man: second wish.

genie: go on.

man: another sandwich.

cop: YOU'RE DOING IT AGAIN.

genie: ah. redundancy. my favorite.

[POP.]

[another sandwich appears.]

genie: hoagie roll. i had extras.

man: amazing.

cop: we're doomed.

[pooh begins humming nearby.]

pooh: red sun in the sky

[he starts dancing. small hops. claps.]

pooh: shines on the motherland

man: wow.

cop: i can't process this anymore.

[pooh spins. he sings with the joy of a child who just discovered rhythm.]

pooh: la la la la

[generals awkwardly clap along. the man looks back at the genie.]

man: okay. final wish.

genie: make it count.

man: i want the honey swingset.

[pooh gasps mid-spin.]

pooh: THE SWING.

man: plus a hoagie.

cop: YOU ALREADY GOT TWO.

genie: actually i have too many sandwiches.

man: perfect.

genie: wish accepted.

[the ground shakes. golden honey erupts from nowhere. beams assemble themselves. a massive swingset forms. thick. glossy. extremely sticky. pooh stares in awe.]

pooh: ...it's beautiful.

[POP.]

[a hoagie drops into the man's hands.]

genie: balance restored.

man: thanks.

genie: do not squander genius.

[he salutes. the genie vanishes back into the lamp. the lamp crumbles into chalk.]

cop: ...did that just happen.

man: yes.

[pooh sprints. he leaps onto the honey swing.]

pooh: WHEEEEEEEEE.

[he laughs uncontrollably.]

pooh: i AM FREE.

[he swings forward. chew. he swings back. chew.]

pooh: THIS IS EVERYTHING i DREAMED OF

cop: he's consuming national infrastructure.

man: multitasking.

[pooh raises one sticky paw while mid-swing.]

pooh: ATTENTION MY ARMY

[the tanks stop. every soldier snaps to attention.]

pooh: YOU WILL GIVE THESE GENTLEMEN THE BEST TANK OR
YOU WILL RECEIVE FOUR HUNDRED YEARS IN THE
PLAYGROUND

[gasps.]

soldier: sir... four hundred?

pooh: SWINGS AND SLIDES FOR CENTURIES.

[silence. the top tank immediately rolls forward. its engine hums nervously.]

general #1: we have the tank ready

pooh: excellent.

[pooh takes another bite out of the swing. the beam snaps. he keeps swinging anyway.]

pooh: WHEEEEEEEEE

man: i think we're good.

cop: grab the tank and RUN.

[a voice erupts directly behind them.]

doc brown:
CONGRATULATIONSGENTLEMENEXCELLENTEXECUTIONOFGEOP
OLITICALLYUNSOUNDYETSCIENTIFICALLYOPTIMALSTRATEGY!!!

cop: WHAT.

man: WHEN DID YOU GET HERE.

doc brown is suddenly there.

doc brown: JUSTNOW!!!

cop: that's not an answer.

doc brown:
YOUHAVESUCCESSFULLYACQUIREDONEOFTWOREQUIREDCOMP
ONENTS!!!

man: wait.

cop: how many.

doc brown: TWO!!!

cop: NOT AGAIN.

man: oh this is gonna be fun.

cop: NO IT IS NOT.

[the cop pulls out his water bottle.]

cop: i am protesting.

[he dumps it on his own head. the water hits. it freezes instantly. solid ice.]

cop: i HATE TIME TRAVEL.

man: you look refreshed.

[metal clamps snap shut around them.]

cop: WHAT NOW.

doc brown: TIMEISOFTHENONEXISTENTESSENCE

[a time machine suddenly exists where there was nothing.]

cop: IT WASNT THERE.

man: neat.

[the tank is yanked inside. the man and cop are dragged in after it.]

cop: i DID NOT AGREE TO THIS.

PART VIII

doc brown: NEXTSTOP!!!

[he slams a random lever.]

doc brown: POLAND!!!

cop: why Poland.

doc brown: NINETEENTHIRTYFIVE!!!

cop: THAT WAS NOT MY QUESTION.

man: I've heard of Poland.

cop: everyone has heard of Poland.

doc brown: IMPORTANTHISTORICALOBJECT!!!

cop: please do not say tank.

doc brown: MUSTACHE!!!

[the cop goes silent.]

cop: ...what.

doc brown: EXTREMELYPOWERFUL!!!

cop: a mustache is not a power source.

doc brown: THISONEIS!!!

man: cool.

cop: NO.

doc brown: PREPAREFORIMPACT!!!

cop: WAIT-

[FWOOOOOOOOOOOSH]

[the time machine crashes directly into a public park. birds explode out of trees. a statue tips over politely.]

man: yay!

cop: i HATE EUROPE NOW.

[the tank slowly rolls halfway out of the machine.]

doc brown: PERFECTLANDING

cop: we destroyed a statue.

doc brown: TEMPORARYARCHITECTURALRELOCATION!!!

[whistles blow. boots march. several german police officers rush in immediately.]

officer #1: HALT

cop: ah.

officer #2: WHAT IS THIS VEHICLE

man: tank.

officer #1: YOU ARE TRESPASSING ON PUBLIC PROPERTY

cop: technically the tank is.

officer #2: YOU WILL COME WITH US

man: where.

officer #1: JAIL

cop: see this is what happens when we time travel.

officer #2: HANDS UP

[the man raises one hand. the cop raises both. doc brown raises a clipboard.]

doc brown: ABSOLUTELYNOT!!!

officer #1: excuse me?

[doc brown suddenly steps forward. his eyes widen. his hair becomes even louder.]

doc brown:

THE VECTOR OF THIS SITUATION IS ENTIRELY MISALIGNED WITH PRO
PER SCIENTIFIC PROCEDURE!!!

officer #2: ...what.

doc brown:

IF YOU TAKE US INTO POLICE CUSTODY THE INEVITABLE TEMPORAL P
ARADOX WILL RESULT IN A CAUSAL LOOP CAUSING SPACETIME FRA
CTURING AT APPROXIMATELY!!!

[he scribbles numbers violently.]

doc brown:

TWENTY SEVEN POINT FIVE METERS FROM YOUR LEFT BOOT!!!

[officer #1 slowly looks at his boot.]

doc brown:
WHICH WILL INITIATE A GRAVITATIONAL COLLAPSE SIMILAR TO A MICROCOPIC BLACK HOLE!!!

officer #2: ...

doc brown: DO YOU WANT A BLACK HOLE!!!

officer #1: no.

doc brown: GOOD!!!

cop: ...

doc brown: BECAUSE THEN NON-EUCLIDEAN GEOMETRY OF THIS VEHICLE ALREADY VIOLATES THREE KNOWN AXIOMS OF CLASSICAL PHYSICS!!!

officer #2: ...

officer #1: ...

officer #2: that sounds extremely illegal.

doc brown: EXACTLY!!!

[officer #1 whispers to officer #2.]

officer #1: this is too smart.

officer #2: far too smart.

officer #1: possibly future science.

officer #2: i do not trust future science.

officer #1: me neither.

[they slowly back away.]

officer #1: we were never here.

officer #2: absolutely never.

[the officers run away.]

cop: ...

man: wow.

cop: you scared them with math.

doc brown: MATHEMATICISVERYINTIMIDATING!!!

man: nice job.

[doc brown suddenly freezes.]

doc brown: DAGNAMMIT!!!

cop: what now.

[doc brown checks his pockets rapidly.]

doc brown: THISISVERYBAD!!!

cop: WHAT.

doc brown: IONLYBROUGHTTWO!!!

man: two what.

doc brown: SUNGLASSES!!!

cop: that's not a problem.

doc brown: IALWAYSBRINGTHREE!!!

cop: that is not a rule.

doc brown: ITISMYRULE!!!

[he looks deeply upset.]

doc brown:
WITHOUTTHETHIRDSUNGLASSESTHESCIENTIFICBALANCEISDIST
URBED!!!

cop: THAT IS NOT HOW SCIENCE WORKS.

doc brown: IMUSTRETRIEVETHEM!!!

man: from where.

doc brown: HOME!!!

cop: that's in the future.

doc brown: EXACTLY!!!

cop: we are in the past.

doc brown: YES!!!

cop: THE TIME MACHINE IS HERE.

doc brown: GOODPOINT!!!

[doc thinks.]

doc brown: IWILLWALK!!!

cop: WALK WHERE.

doc brown: THROUGHTIME!!!

cop: YOU CANNOT WALK THROUGH TIME.

doc brown: WATCHME!!!

[doc presses a small blinking button on his bulletproof vest.]

doc brown: GOODLUCKGENTLEMEN!!!

cop: WAIT WHAT ABOUT THE MUSTACHE.

doc brown: OHRIGHT!!!

[doc points dramatically into the distance.]

doc brown: YOUMUSTACQUIRETHESACREDMUSTACHE!!!

man: cool.

cop: whose mustache.

doc brown: MUSTACHEMAN!!!

man: but who is mustache man?

doc brown: EXACTLY!!!

cop: THAT DOESN'T HELP.

doc brown:

IWILLRETURNSHORTLYAFTEREXACTLYFOURMINUTESANDSEVENTYTWOSECONDS!!!

cop: DO NOT LEAVE US IN 1935 EUROPE.

doc brown: SCIENCEWAITSFORNOMAN!!!

[doc brown suddenly vanishes into thin air.]

[silence.]

[a leaf falls.]

cop: ...

man: ...

cop: he just disappeared.

man: yep.

cop: we are alone.

man: yep.

cop: in Poland.

man: yep.

cop: in 1935.

man: yep.

[they both slowly look at the tank.]

cop: we cannot drive that around.

man: why not.

cop: BECAUSE IT IS A FUTURE CHINESE TANK.

man: fair.

cop: also we need a mustache.

man: true.

cop: from someone called mustache man.

man: probably a guy with a mustache.

cop: EVERYONE HAS A MUSTACHE IN 1935.

man: good point.

[they both pause.]

man: we could ask.

cop: ask who.

[a distant marching sound begins somewhere in the city.]

cop: ...

man: ...

cop: i have a terrible feeling.

man: me too.

cop: this is going to be historically bad.

man: probably.

[the tank engine quietly turns on by itself.]

cop: let's review our situation.

man: okay.

cop: we are stranded in 1935.

man: correct.

cop: with a chinese tank.

[the man squints dramatically.]

man: wait.

cop: what.

man: maybe mustache man is just...

cop: just what.

man: a man.

cop: yes.

man: with a mustache.

cop: YES.

man: that narrows it down.

cop: THAT DOES NOT NARROW IT DOWN.

[they both pause.]

man: hmm.

cop: hmm.

man: but who the heck is mustache man-

???: NEIN

[the man and cop both jump about three feet into the air.]

cop: AAAAAAAAAA-

man: WOW-

[a short man with a very intense posture and a very specific mustache is standing behind them.]

[he folds his arms dramatically.]

mustache man: NEIN. you vill not insult ze mustache.

cop: oh.

man: oh.

cop: that's probably him.

man: yeah.

mustache man: I AM MUSTACHE MAN.

[he strikes a pose.]

mustache man: FEAR MY FACIAL HAIR.

cop: wow.

man: impressive.

cop: concerning.

mustache man: my mustache is ze legendary.

man: cool.

mustache man: it represents ze power.

cop: okay.

mustache man: discipline.

man: nice.

mustache man: and also ze branding.

cop: branding?

[mustache man leans toward the man.]

mustache man: i refuse to say my real name.

cop: why.

mustache man: because then this story becomes rated r.

man: fair.

mustache man: and also lawyers.

cop: very fair.

mustache man: therefore i am simply mustache man

man: wow.

cop: okay but we actually need your mustache.

[mustache man freezes.]

mustache man: ...what.

cop: for science.

mustache man: NEIN.

man: understandable.

mustache man: my mustache is unique. unmatched. unrivaled. it is the ONLY mustache like it in ze world.

man: hmm.

cop: don't.

man: i have an idea.

cop: no.

man: wait here.

cop: WAIT-

[the man runs away.]

cop: YOU CAN'T JUST LEAVE ME HERE WITH-

[six hours later, the man returns. holding a small bag.]

cop: WHERE WERE YOU.

man: dollar store.

cop: FOR SIX HOURS.

man: traffic.

cop: THIS IS 1935.

man: horse traffic.

cop: ...

man: anyway.

[the man reaches into the bag.]

mustache man: nothing can rival my mustache.

man: check this out.

[the man sticks a brand-new identical mustache on his face.]

man: ta-da!

[silence.]

[mustache man stares.]

mustache man: NEIN-

[he collapses instantly.]

[THUD]

cop: wow.

man: he fainted.

cop: you destroyed his identity.

man: i bought it for 3 dollars.

cop: history is fragile.

[the cop sighs and rubs his face.]

cop: i just want to go back to normal life.

man: same.

cop: no tanks.

man: fair.

cop: no time travel.

man: reasonable.

cop: no magic genies.

man: understandable.

cop: no honey swingsets.

man: tragic but fair.

cop: and definitely no more bad ideas-

[a distant rumble. the man and cop turns exactly 76.12° counterclockwise. a guy in a green hoodie sprints past them.]

dream: LEAVE ME ALONE

[behind him six people charge with swords.]

george: HE WENT THIS WAY

sapnap: GET HIM

bad: DREAM STOP RUNNING

ant: HE'S LOW

sam: CUT HIM OFF

puffy: DON'T LET HIM GET AWAY

[the entire group runs straight past the man and cop. they do not even look at them. the chase disappears down the street.]

cop: ...

man: ...

cop slowly lowers his head.

cop: i said the word "bad."

man: you did.

[the cop facepalms extremely hard.]

cop: OF COURSE THAT SUMMONS THEM.

man: neat crossover.

cop: i HATE THIS TIMELINE.

[in the background, mustache man is still unconscious.]

man: wait.

cop: what now.

man: the mustache.

cop: yes. the mustache that destroyed that guy emotionally.

[mustache man is still unconscious on the ground.]

mustache man: ...nein...

man: what if this counts.

cop: counts for what.

man: the thing doc wanted.

cop: the sacred mustache?

man: yeah.

cop: that sounds illegal.

man: but look.

[the man points proudly at his identical mustache.]

man: i have one.

cop: you bought it at a store.

man: still a mustache.

cop: i hate how your logic works.

doc brown: THATWILLABSOLUTELYWORK!!!

cop: AAAAAA-

man: wow.

[doc brown is standing behind them again. no one saw him arrive. his hair is even louder than before.]

cop: STOP DOING THAT

man: when did you get here.

doc brown: JUSTNOW!!!

cop: THAT IS NOT AN ANSWER.

doc brown: EXCELLENTWORKGENTLEMEN!!!

[doc inspects the mustache carefully like a scientist studying a rare mineral.]

doc brown: PERFECTDIMENSIONS!!!

cop: you're evaluating a fake mustache.

doc brown: SCIENCEISFLEXIBLE!!!

man: nice.

doc brown:
THISMUSTACHEWILLSTABILIZETHEBARYONICFLUXOFTHEBUCK
SCAPACITOR!!!

cop: the what capacitor.

doc brown: THEBUCKSCAPACITOR!!!

cop: that sounds fake.

doc brown: ITISVERYREAL!!!

man: neat.

[doc brown suddenly puts on a third pair of sunglasses.]

cop: THREE SUNGLASSES?

doc brown: YES!!!

cop: YOU ALREADY HAD TWO.

doc brown: IFOUNDTHETHIRD!!!

man: where was it.

doc brown: INMYSPACESHIPSJANITORCLOSET!!!

cop: your spaceship has a janitor closet.

doc brown: EVERYGOODLABORATORYHASONE!!!

cop: that is not a laboratory.

doc brown:
TECHNICALLYITISAMOBILETEMPORALRESEARCHFACILITY!!!

cop: it's a car.

doc brown: AVERYSMARTCAR!!!

[doc claps his hands.]

doc brown: NOWLETUSRETURNTO-

[they turn toward the time machine. there is a sticky note on it.]

cop: ...

man: ...

cop: why is there a sticky note.

[man walks over and reads it.]

man: huh.

cop: what does it say.

man: "the united states government has confiscated the bucks capacitor in order to keep the country safe."

cop: NOOOOOOOOOOOO.

man: what.

cop: THEY TOOK IT.

man: who.

cop: THE GOVERNMENT.

man: which one.

cop: THE U.S. GOVERNMENT.

man: we're in Poland.

cop: i KNOW.

man: in 1935.

cop: i KNOW.

man: that seems inefficient.

[the cop begins groaning loudly.]

cop: THIS IS WHY TIME TRAVEL IS A BAD IDEA.

man: you said bad again.

cop: DON'T SAY IT.

man: okay.

cop: they confiscated the capacitor.

man: what does that mean.

cop: IT MEANS WE ARE STUCK.

man: oh.

cop: FOREVER.

man: oh.

cop: IN 1935.

man: oh.

cop: WITH A TANK.

man: oh.

[doc brown suddenly clears his throat.]

doc brown: AHEM!!!

cop: WHAT.

[doc brown proudly pulls something out of his coat.]

doc brown: SECONDBUCKSCAPACITOR!!!

man: wow.

cop: WHAT.

doc brown: IBOUGHTIT!!!

cop: FROM WHO.

doc brown: THEUSGOVERNMENT!!!

cop: HOW.

doc brown: FIVEDOLLARS!!!

cop: FIVE DOLLARS???

doc brown: THEYHADONEFORSALE!!!

man: good deal.

cop: YOU BOUGHT A CRITICAL TIME TRAVEL COMPONENT FOR FIVE DOLLARS.

doc brown: ITWASONSALE!!!

cop: i HATE EVERYTHING.

doc brown: LETUSASSEMBLETHEREQUIREDCOMPONENTS!!!

[doc opens the time machine. inside is a growing pile of ridiculous items.]

doc brown: INSERTTHETANK!!!

[the tank slowly rolls inside.]

doc brown: INSERTTHEMUSTACHE!!!

[the man peels his mustache off.]

man: goodbye friend.

[doc places it into a glowing slot.]

[DING]

cop: that worked.

doc brown: SCIENCE!!!

cop: I DON'T LIKE HOW YOU SAID THAT.

[they climb inside.]

doc brown: NEXTDESTINATION!!!

cop: please be normal.

doc brown: WALMART!!!

cop: that's not a country.

doc brown: THEORETICALLYITIS!!!

man: makes sense.

cop: IT DOES NOT.

doc brown: INITIATINGDEPARTURE!!!

[lights flash. engines roar.]

doc brown: PREPAREFORTEMPORALDISPLACEMENT!!!

cop: WAIT-

[a screen pops up out of nowhere]

"ERROR: DESTINATION FAILURE. GEOGRAPHICAL PARADOX.
WALMART NOT RECOGNIZED AS COUNTRY"

doc brown: THATISUNFORTUNATE!!!

man: what happens now.

[the machine begins shaking violently.]

cop: i DO NOT LIKE THAT.

doc brown: SYSTEMRECALCULATING!!!

man: recalculating what.

doc brown: EVERYTHING!!!

[the tank honks again.]

cop: STOP HONKING-

[FWOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOSH]

[the time machine floats slowly through empty space. the tank floats slightly sideways.]

man: wow.

cop: WHY ARE WE IN SPACE.

man: neat view.

cop: WE ARE GOING TO DIE.

man: probably.

cop: ALSO HOW ARE WE BREATHING.

man: good question.

cop: WE ARE LITERALLY IN SPACE.

man: maybe the tank has oxygen.

cop: THAT IS NOT HOW TANKS WORK.

[doc brown calmly adjusts his second pair of sunglasses.]

doc brown: DONOTPANIC!!!

cop: WE ARE IN SPACE.

doc brown: CORRECT!!!

cop: THAT IS A PANIC SITUATION.

doc brown: LETMECALCULATE!!!

[doc suddenly pulls out a calculator, three clipboards, and a glowing ruler.]

doc brown: HMMMM!!!

man: wow.

cop: WHAT ARE YOU DOING.

doc brown: USINGSCIENCE!!!

[he scribbles numbers extremely fast.]

doc brown:

IFWEASSUMETHERELATIVEVELOCITYOFTHETEMPORALDISPLACEMENTVECTORWASOFFSETBYTHEGEOGRAPHICALPARADOXTHE
N-

cop: SPEAK ENGLISH.

doc brown: WEACCIDENTALLYDROVEINTOSPACE!!!

cop: i FIGURED THAT OUT.

doc brown:

IFWETRANSMITAGRAVITATIONALSIGNATUREUSINGTHEMASSOF
THETANKWECOULD-

[the entire ship suddenly shakes.]

man: uh.

cop: WHAT WAS THAT.

[a massive red light appears outside the window.]

man: wow.

cop: WHAT IS THAT.

[doc brown slowly looks out the window]

doc brown: OH!!!

cop: WHAT OH.

[a giant moon-shaped structure looms nearby. A beam of light locks onto them.]

doc brown: TRACTORBEAM!!!

cop: THAT IS NOT GOOD.

man: we're being vacuumed.

cop: THAT IS NOT A WORD.

[the time machine slowly drifts toward the enormous structure.]

cop: WHAT IS THAT THING.

doc brown: THATAPPEARSTOBE-

[a giant metal label is visible.]

"DEATH STAR 3.0"

cop: THREE???

man: what happened to one.

cop: AN A-10 DESTROYED IT.

man: what happened to two.

cop: YOU KILLED IT WITH A MIRROR.

man: what happened to four.

cop: WRONG STORY.

[the beam pulls them inside. stormtroopers soon surround them.]

stormtrooper #1: HALT.

cop: oh come on.

man: hi.

stormtrooper #2: IDENTIFY YOURSELVES.

cop: lost.

stormtrooper #1: YOU ARE TRESPASSING ON IMPERIAL PROPERTY.

cop: THIS KEEPS HAPPENING.

stormtrooper #2: YOU ARE COMING WITH US.

[stormtroopers grab the man and cop, but leave doc because he's too scary and smart to be a prisoner.]

man: gentle please.

cop: WE ARE CIVILIANS.

[the tank honks.]

stormtrooper #3: WHAT IS THAT VEHICLE.

cop: long story.

stormtrooper #1: MOVE.

[the stormtroopers march the man and cop down a long corridor.]

stormtrooper #2: THE PRISON CELL IS THIS WAY.

[they pass the door.]

stormtrooper #1: ...wait.

stormtrooper #3: WAS THAT THE DOOR.

stormtrooper #2: MAYBE.

stormtrooper #1: KEEP WALKING.

cop: wow.

man: very organized.

[they keep walking.]

stormtrooper #3: i THINK WE MISSED IT.

stormtrooper #2: TURN AROUND.

[they all awkwardly turn around.]

stormtrooper #1: IT WAS THIS DOOR.

[they walk past it again.]

stormtrooper #3: ...

stormtrooper #2: WE MISSED IT AGAIN.

cop: impressive.

man: two for two.

stormtrooper #1: QUIET.

[heavy breathing echoes. slow mechanical footsteps approach.]

cop: oh no.

man: oh yes.

[a tall black figure appears.]

darth vader: ...

stormtrooper #1: LORD VADER.

stormtrooper #2: WE ARE ESCORTING PRISONERS.

[darth vader looks at the door. then the troopers. then the door again. then the troopers again.]

darth vader: ...

[he sighs through the mask.]

darth vader: incompetent.

[he force-pushes everyone.]

WHOOMPH

[stormtroopers, the man, and the cop all fly into the correct room. the door slams shut.]

[CLANK]

[silence.]

cop: ...

man: ...

stormtrooper #1: ...

stormtrooper #2: ...

stormtrooper #3: ...

[they slowly look around.]

stormtrooper #1: ...

stormtrooper #2: ...

stormtrooper #3: ...

stormtrooper #1: wait.

stormtrooper #2: ...

stormtrooper #3: ...

stormtrooper #1: the door locked.

cop: yep.

stormtrooper #2: WE ARE IN THE CELL.

man: welcome.

stormtrooper #3: OPEN THE DOOR.

[they try the control panel.]

"ACCESS DENIED"

stormtrooper #1: ...

stormtrooper #2: ...

stormtrooper #3: ...

all stormtroopers: NOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOO-

[the tank honks outside the cell.]

PART IX

man: so.

cop: we are in a prison cell.

man: correct.

cop: with stormtroopers.

man: also correct.

stormtrooper #2: THIS IS NOT HOW THIS IS SUPPOSED TO WORK.

stormtrooper #1: i WAS PROMISED AUTHORITY.

stormtrooper #3: i WAS PROMISED A DOOR.

cop: you got a door.

stormtrooper #3: IT DOES NOT OPEN.

man: skill issue.

cop: don't antagonize the armed soldiers.

stormtrooper #2: WE ARE NOT ARMED.

[they all look down. their weapons are still outside the cell.]

stormtrooper #1: ...

stormtrooper #2: ...

stormtrooper #3: ...

cop: wow.

man: that's rough.

stormtrooper #1: I WILL CALL LORD VADER.

[he pulls out a smartphone.]

cop: of course you have that.

stormtrooper #1: TECHNOLOGY.

[he starts dialing.]

stormtrooper #1: ...wait.

stormtrooper #2: what.

stormtrooper #1: I FORGOT THE NUMBER.

stormtrooper #3: IT IS 1-800-VADER.

stormtrooper #1: THAT IS TOO MANY LETTERS.

stormtrooper #2: JUST TYPE IT.

[stormtrooper #1 types.]

stormtrooper #1: ...it says "invalid."

stormtrooper #3: TRY AGAIN.

[he types again.]

stormtrooper #1: ...I ADDED AN EXTRA 7.

stormtrooper #2: WHY.

stormtrooper #1: FOR SAFETY.

stormtrooper #2: THAT IS NOT HOW NUMBERS WORK.

[they keep typing.]

stormtrooper #3: i THINK IT IS 1-800-8237.

stormtrooper #1: THAT DOES NOT SPELL VADER.

stormtrooper #2: MAYBE IT IS ROMAN NUMERALS.

stormtrooper #3: THAT WOULD BE MORE CONFUSING.

[they all begin aggressively typing wrong numbers.]

cop: they know the number.

man: yeah.

cop: and they are still getting it wrong.

man: impressive.

cop: this is our guard.

man: we can escape.

cop: we cannot escape.

man: i have an idea.

cop: no.

man: yes.

cop: your ideas are always bad.

man: this one uses cheats.

cop: THAT IS WORSE.

[the man squints at the wall.]

man: okay.

cop: what are you doing.

man: enabling noclip.

cop: YOU CANNOT ENABLE NOCLIP IN REAL LIFE.

man: watch me.

[the man presses absolutely nothing.]

man: done.

cop: you didn't do anything.

man: i did it mentally.

cop: THAT IS NOT HOW CHEATS WORK-

[the man casually walks directly through the wall.]

cop: NO.

[the man pokes his head back through the wall.]

man: it worked.

cop: YOU CAN'T JUST WALK THROUGH SOLID OBJECTS.

man: skill.

cop: NO.

stormtrooper #1: i GOT VOICEMAIL.

stormtrooper #2: WHAT DID IT SAY.

stormtrooper #1: "PLEASE ENTER A VALID NUMBER."

stormtrooper #3: TRY AGAIN.

[they continue typing wrong numbers.]

man: come on.

cop: i REFUSE TO ACCEPT THIS.

man: trust the process.

cop: THERE IS NO PROCESS.

[the man reaches through the wall, grabs the cop's arm, and pulls.]

[the cop phases through the wall.]

cop: AAAAAAAAAA-

[they are now outside the cell.]

cop: ...

cop: i FEEL WRONG.

man: you look normal.

cop: i DO NOT FEEL NORMAL.

[the tank honks approvingly.]

man: hi tank.

cop: DO NOT GREET THE TANK.

[inside the cell, the stormtroopers are still dialing.]

stormtrooper #2: I ADDED A ZERO.

stormtrooper #1: WHY.

stormtrooper #2: FOR LONG DISTANCE.

stormtrooper #3: WE ARE IN SPACE.

stormtrooper #2: EXACTLY.

cop: they are never getting out.

man: nope.

cop: good.

[the man walks to the control panel and presses a button.]

[the cell door opens.]

stormtrooper #1: ...

stormtrooper #2: ...

stormtrooper #3: ...

stormtrooper #1: OH COME ON.

stormtrooper #2: IT WAS ONE BUTTON???

stormtrooper #3: i HATE TECHNOLOGY.

cop: bye.

[the man and cop casually walk away.]

[they turn a corner.]

cop: okay.

cop: new plan.

man: what plan.

cop: we leave.

man: good plan.

cop: we find doc.

man: better plan.

doc brown: EXCELLENTPLAN!!!

cop: AAAAAAAAAA-

man: wow.

[doc brown is standing behind them again. no one saw him arrive. his hair is now at maximum volume.]

cop: STOP DOING THAT.

man: hi doc.

doc brown: GREETINGSGENTLEMEN!!!

cop: WHERE WERE YOU.

doc brown: PLAYINGUNO!!!

cop: WITH WHO.

doc brown: DARTHVADER!!!

cop: WHAT.

doc brown: IWON!!!

man: nice.

cop: YOU PLAYED UNO WITH THE MAIN VILLAIN.

doc brown: HEFORGOTTOSAYUNO!!!

cop: THAT'S HOW HE LOST???

doc brown: RULESAREIMPORTANT!!!

man: true.

doc brown: ASAREWARD!!!

[doc gestures dramatically.]

doc brown: THEDEATHSTARHREEPOINTOHISNOWMINE!!!

cop: YOU WON A SPACE STATION.

doc brown: YES!!!

cop: IN A CARD GAME.

doc brown: YES!!!

cop: i HATE THIS UNIVERSE.

doc brown: IWASJUSTABOUTTORESCUEYOU!!!

cop: WE ALREADY ESCAPED.

doc brown: EVENBETTER!!!

man: we used noclip.

doc brown: EXCELLENTUSEOFCHEATS!!!

cop: STOP ENCOURAGING HIM.

doc brown: FOLLOWME!!!

[doc starts walking confidently down the hallway.]

[alarms are not going off because no one knows what's happening.]

man: where are we going.

doc brown: SHIP!!!

cop: please be normal.

doc brown: DEFINITELYNORMAL!!!

[they enter a hangar.]

[a sleek futuristic ship sits there. it looks extremely familiar.]

cop: that is not normal.

man: cool ship.

cop: THAT IS A STAR TREK SHIP.

doc brown: TECHNICALLYBORROWED!!!

cop: YOU STOLE IT.

doc brown: TEMPORARYACQUISITION!!!

man: nice.

[the tank slowly rolls in behind them.]

cop: WHY IS THE TANK COMING.

doc brown: ITISPARTOFTHESYSTEMNOW!!!

cop: OF COURSE IT IS.

[they all board the ship.]

doc brown: AUTOPILOTENGAGED!!!

cop: where are we going.

doc brown: EARTH!!!

man: finally.

cop: THANK YOU.

doc brown: HOWEVER!!!

cop: NO.

doc brown: IMUSTDEPART!!!

cop: WHAT.

doc brown: THEREISANANOMALY!!!

man: where.

doc brown: THETWENTYFIRSTDIMENSION!!!

cop: THAT IS TOO MANY DIMENSIONS.

doc brown: SCIENCEDEMANDSIT!!!

cop: STAY WITH US.

doc brown: IMPOSSIBLE!!!

[doc presses a button on his watch.]

doc brown: GOODLUCK!!!

cop: STOP LEAVING-

[doc brown gets sucked into a swirling portal.]

[silence.]

man: ...

cop: HE DID IT AGAIN.

man: yep.

[the ship hums.]

autopilot: DESTINATION LOCKED

cop: okay.

cop: we're going home.

man: nice.

[the ship suddenly warps.]

[stars stretch. space bends.]

cop: i HATE THAT FEELING.

[the ship lands.]

[silence.]

man: are we home.

cop: i hope so.

[the door opens.]

[they step outside.]

[they look around.]

[silence.]

cop: ...

man: ...

cop: this is not right.

man: yeah.

cop: where are the buildings.

man: good question.

[the outside is completely unexpected .]

[no sky. no clouds.]

[no atmosphere.]

[just black space above a cracked, glowing surface.]

[giant rivers of lava crawl through the ground like angry spaghetti.]

[the planet looks half-finished.]

man: wow.

cop: THAT IS NOT EARTH.

man: it looks like earth.

cop: EARTH DOES NOT LOOK LIKE A BURNING ROCK IN SPACE.

man: maybe it's under construction.

cop: PLANETS ARE NOT BUILT LIKE HOUSES.

[the man leans out slightly.]

cop: DO NOT LEAN OUT.

man: there's no air.

cop: EXACTLY.

man: i can't breathe.

cop: GET BACK IN.

[the man pulls his head back in.]

man: okay.

cop: good.

[they both stare outside.]

cop: where is the ocean.

man: gone.

cop: where are the trees.

man: gone.

cop: WHERE IS THE MOON.

man: also gone.

cop: THAT IS VERY CONCERNING.

[the ground outside bubbles violently.]

man: lava.

cop: i SEE THE LAVA.

man: it's everywhere.

cop: IT SHOULD NOT BE EVERYWHERE.

[they both slowly step back from the door.]

cop: we are not landing.

man: agreed.

cop: we are leaving.

man: agreed.

doc brown: CORRECTDECISION!!!

cop: AAAAAAAAAA-

man: wow.

[doc brown is suddenly inside the already cramped shuttle, somehow between them.]

cop: THERE IS NO ROOM IN HERE.

man: hi doc.

doc brown: GREETINGSGENTLEMEN!!!

cop: WHERE DID YOU COME FROM.

doc brown: THETWENTYFIRSTDIMENSION!!!

cop: OF COURSE YOU DID.

man: why is earth like this.

doc brown: YOURACTIONSINPOLAND!!!

cop: WHAT DID WE DO.

doc brown: MINORTEMPORALDISRUPTION!!!

cop: HOW MINOR.

doc brown: MICROSCOPIC!!!

cop: THAT DOES NOT SOUND BAD.

doc brown: ITSHIFTEDTHETIMELINEBYAPPROXIMATELY-

[he checks a glowing watch.]

doc brown: -FIVEMINUTES!!!

cop: THAT IS NOT MICROSCOPIC.

doc brown: RELATIVELYITIS!!!

man: so what year is it.

doc brown: SEVENTEENOHTHREE!!!

cop: NO IT IS NOT.

doc brown: TECHNICALLYYESITIS!!!

man: so earth is... new.

doc brown: PROTOEARTH!!!

cop: i DO NOT LIKE THAT WORD.

[the ship suddenly makes a loud cracking noise.]

cop: what was that.

man: uh.

doc brown: THATISPROBLEMATIC!!!

cop: WHAT IS.

[another crack. the walls flicker.]

autopilot: ERROR

cop: i REALLY DO NOT LIKE THAT.

doc brown: THEEXCESSIVETEMPORALTRAVEL!!!

man: yeah.

doc brown: HASDESTABILIZEDTHESHIP!!!

cop: SPEAK ENGLISH.

doc brown: ITISBREAKING!!!

cop: THAT IS BAD.

[the floor shifts slightly.]

man: we're tilting.

cop: WE ARE FALLING.

[the ship begins to shake violently.]

autopilot: CRITICAL FAILURE

man: wow.

cop: DO SOMETHING.

doc brown: ICANNOT!!!

cop: WHY.

doc brown: ITISALREADYTOOLATE!!!

cop: i HATE THAT SENTENCE.

[the ship starts tearing apart mid-air.]

[RRRRRRIP]

[panels fly off into space.]

man: oh.

cop: OH NO.

[the tank slides past them slowly.]

[HONK]

cop: NOT THE TANK.

[the tank gets sucked out into space.]

man: goodbye tank.

[the ship fully breaks apart.]

[BOOOOOOOM]

[the man, the cop, and doc are now floating in space above proto-earth.]

[silence.]

cop: WE ARE IN SPACE.

man: yep.

cop: AGAIN.

doc brown: CORRECT!!!

cop: i AM GOING TO-

[before he can finish, something fast streaks past them.]

man: what was that.

cop: i DO NOT KNOW.

[another blur. closer this time.]

doc brown: INTERESTING!!!

cop: DO NOT SAY THAT.

[the object suddenly stops.]

[silence.]

man: ...

cop: ...

[they slowly turn.]

[a strange, glowing craft hovers nearby. it makes absolutely no sound.]

cop: i DO NOT LIKE THAT.

man: me neither.

[beam of light shoots out.]

[ZZZZZZZZAP]

cop: OH COME ON-

[the man, cop, and doc are instantly pulled upward.]

man: wheeee-

cop: AAAAAAAAAAAAAA-

doc brown: FASCINATING!!!

[they vanish into the craft.]

[silence.]

[darkness.]

[then light.]

[the man, the cop, and doc are floating inside a massive metallic chamber.]

[everything hums. walls stretch endlessly in every direction.]

cop: ...

man: ...

cop: we got abducted.

man: yep.

cop: AGAIN.

man: yep.

doc brown: FASCINATING!!!

cop: STOP ENJOYING THIS.

[small clanking noises approach.]

[tick tick tick tick]

man: what's that.

cop: i don't know.

[they look down.]

[hundreds of tiny robots-each about the size of a pea-march toward them in formation.]

man: ...

cop: those are very small.

man: tiny.

[one tiny robot climbs onto a slightly bigger box to look taller.]

tiny robot #1: HALT

cop: i could step on you.

tiny robot #1: DO NOT STEP ON ME

man: sorry.

tiny robot #2: YOU ARE UNDER ARREST

cop: BY WHO.

tiny robot #2: US

cop: YOU ARE THE SIZE OF A SNACK.

tiny robot #3: WE ARE VERY EVIL

man: wow.

cop: i AM NOT INTIMIDATED.

tiny robot #1: YOU SHOULD BE

[one robot dramatically pulls out a microscopic laser.]

[the laser lightly taps the cop's shoe.]

cop: that tickled.

tiny robot #1: MAXIMUM POWER

cop: that is not maximum anything.

doc brown: INTRIGUING!!!

tiny robot #2: IDENTIFY THE SMART ONE

[all robots turn toward doc.]

doc brown: HELLO!!!

tiny robot #3: HE IS TOO SMART.

tiny robot #1: WE CANNOT JAIL HIM.

cop: that's convenient.

tiny robot #2: SEPARATE HIM.

man: bye doc.

cop: DO NOT LEAVE US WITH THE PEAS.

doc brown: GOODLUCKGENTLEMEN!!!

cop: STOP SAYING THAT-

[dozens of tiny robots swarm doc and carry him away somehow.]

doc brown: SCIENCEAWAITS!!!

[he disappears around a corner.]

cop: ...

cop: great.

man: it's just us now.

tiny robot #1: PRISONERS WILL FOLLOW

cop: YOU ARE FIVE MILLIMETERS TALL.

tiny robot #2: WE HAVE AUTHORITY

man: okay.

[the tiny robots lead them down a gigantic hallway.]

[everything is massive compared to the robots.]

[the man and cop walk normally while the robots struggle to keep up.]

nine hours later...

cop: i AM TIRED.

man: same.

cop: WE HAVE BEEN WALKING FOR NINE HOURS.

man: they're slow.

cop: THEY ARE THE SIZE OF DUST.

tiny robot #1: WE ARE FAST FOR OUR SIZE

cop: THAT DOES NOT HELP ME.

[they finally reach a giant door.]

tiny robot #2: PRESENTING

tiny robot #3: OUR KING

[the doors slowly open.]

[inside stands a larger robot. not huge, but definitely bigger than the others.]

[he turns dramatically.]

johnny 5: NEED INPUT.

cop: ...

man: ...

cop: is that-

johnny 5: I AM JOHNNY 5.

man: cool.

cop: YOU ARE A ROBOT.

johnny 5: CORRECT.

cop: WHY ARE YOU THE KING.

johnny 5: I WON.

cop: WON WHAT.

johnny 5: EVERYTHING.

man: impressive.

johnny 5: YOU ARE HUMAN.

cop: yes.

johnny 5: THAT IS ILLEGAL INPUT.

cop: WHAT.

johnny 5: SENTENCE EQUALS PRISON.

cop: FOR WHAT CRIME.

johnny 5: EXISTING.

cop: THAT IS NOT A CRIME.

johnny 5: IT IS NOW.

man: fair.

cop: NO IT IS NOT.

johnny 5: SENTENCE CONFIRMED.

[he presses a button.]

tiny robot #1: TAKE THEM AWAY.

cop: THIS IS RIDICULOUS.

man: at least it's not lava.

cop: THAT IS A LOW BAR.

[they are escorted away again.]

[another nine hours of walking.]

cop: i AM GOING TO COLLAPSE.

man: we're almost there.

cop: YOU SAID THAT THREE HOURS AGO.

man: still true.

[they finally reach a cell.]

tiny robot #2: ENTER

cop: FINALLY.

[they step inside.]

[the door closes.]

[silence.]

cop: ...

man: ...

cop: we are in jail.

man: yep.

cop: again.

man: yep.

cop: i hate jail.

man: same.

[three seconds pass.]

[the door opens.]

cop: ...

cop: what.

tiny robot #1: YOU ARE FREE TO GO.

cop: WHAT.

tiny robot #2: SENTENCE COMPLETE.

cop: THAT WAS SEVEN SECONDS.

tiny robot #3: CORRECT

cop: WE WALKED FOR EIGHTEEN HOURS.

tiny robot #1: YES

cop: FOR A SEVEN SECOND SENTENCE???

tiny robot #2: OUR KING PRESSED THE WRONG BUTTON

man: happens.

cop: HE MEANT SEVEN YEARS DIDN'T HE.

tiny robot #3: YES

cop: i HATE THIS SHIP.

man: at least we're free.

cop: AFTER SEVEN SECONDS.

tiny robot #1: PLEASE EXIT

cop: GLADLY.

[they walk out.]

cop: we need to find doc.

man: yeah.

cop: and leave this place.

man: yeah.

[behind them, the tiny robots argue.]

tiny robot #2: YOU PRESSED SECONDS.

tiny robot #3: IT WAS CONFUSING.

tiny robot #1: THE BUTTONS ARE CLEARLY LABELED.

tiny robot #3: THEY ARE VERY SMALL.

tiny robot #2: YOU ARE VERY SMALL.

tiny robot #3: YOUR MOM IS VERY SMALL.

tiny robot #1: SHUT UP.

[the man and cop keep walking.]

cop: i cannot believe this.

man: me neither.

cop: seven seconds.

man: worth it.

cop: IT WAS NOT WORTH IT.

[the man and cop walk down the hallway.]

[footsteps rapidly approach.]

[doc brown sprints up to them at full speed, somehow not out of breath. his hair is now scientifically maximum.]

cop: STOP APPEARING.

man: hi doc.

doc brown: EXCELLENTNEWS!!!

cop: i DO NOT TRUST THAT.

doc brown: IWONANOTHERBET!!!

cop: WITH WHO.

doc brown: THEBOT!!!

cop: WHAT DID YOU BET.

doc brown: POKER!!!

cop: YOU PLAYED POKER WITH A ROBOT KING.

doc brown: ANDIWON!!!

man: nice.

cop: WHAT DID YOU WIN.

doc brown: THISSHIP!!!

cop: YOU WON THE ENTIRE SHIP.

doc brown: YES!!!

cop: TWICE IN ONE DAY YOU WON A MASSIVE STRUCTURE.

doc brown: IMVERYGOODATGAMES!!!

man: impressive.

doc brown: NOW

[doc spreads his arms dramatically.]

doc brown: IWILLCOMBINETHISVESSEL!!!

cop: no.

doc brown: WITHTHEDEATHSTARHREEPOINTOH!!!

cop: NO.

doc brown:
TOCREATETHEULTIMATETEMPORALSCIENTIFICPLATFORM!!!

cop: THAT SOUNDS ILLEGAL.

doc brown: SCIENCEISNEVERILLEGAL!!!

cop: THAT IS NOT TRUE.

doc brown: THEENERGYOUTPUTALONEWILLALLOW-

[the lights flicker.]

cop: ...

man: ...

doc brown: ...

[the ship suddenly shakes.]

cop: WHAT WAS THAT.

doc brown: THATWASUNEXPECTED!!!

cop: i DO NOT LIKE THAT TONE.

[the walls begin glitching. parts of the hallway flicker between different places-the death star, prison, 1899, walmart.]

man: wow.

cop: WHY IS WALMART THERE.

doc brown: THESPACETIMECONTINUUM!!!

cop: WHAT ABOUT IT.

doc brown: ISBREAKING!!!

cop: OF COURSE IT IS.

[reality begins to distort. gravity flips for a second, then fixes itself.]

man: I'm sideways.

cop: i AM ALSO SIDEWAYS.

doc brown: THEACCUMULATIONOFTEMPORALDISPLACEMENTS!!!

cop: SPEAK ENGLISH.

doc brown: WETIMETRAVELEDTOOMUCH!!!

cop: i KNEW IT.

[cracks of glowing light appear in midair.]

man: uh.

cop: THAT IS NOT NORMAL.

doc brown: THEUNIVERSEISCOLLAPSINGINONITSELF!!!

cop: GREAT.

[everything begins overlapping. multiple versions of the hallway appear at once.]

[the tiny robots run past them screaming.]

tiny robot #1: SYSTEM FAILURE.

tiny robot #2: WE ARE TOO SMALL FOR THIS.

tiny robot #3: RETREAT.

[the ship folds inward slightly.]

cop: WE ARE GOING TO DIE.

man: probably.

doc brown: HOLDON!!!

cop: TO WHAT.

doc brown: ANYTHING!!!

[the cracks suddenly expand.]

[blinding white light floods everything.]

doc brown: THISISIT-

cop: WHAT DO WE D-

man: I DON'T KN-

[FLASH]

[silence.]

[engine noise.]

[the man sits in a run-down car, driving down a highway.]

man: ...

man: nice day.

[he scratches his head.]

man: i feel like i forgot something.

[he shrugs and keeps driving.]

[on the side of the highway, a cop car sits.]

[inside, the cop drinks coffee.]

cop: i feel like today is going to be annoying.

[he looks up.]

[a run-down car speeds past.]

cop: oh come on.

[he flips on the sirens.]

cop: that's it.

[he pulls out onto the road.]

cop: pull over